

Site 40: 18 – 19/98/1

es-Sahl (A)

Israel grid: 1898 1989

UTM grid: 7274 5858

Elevation: 315 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: concentration of structures and installations

Area: 3 dunams (0.75 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 9

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain Bar-daleh, no. 91), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Salhab – Beth Shean junction (B7), passes by site

Visibility: 2

Mar. 7, 1986; 29 shards

* * *

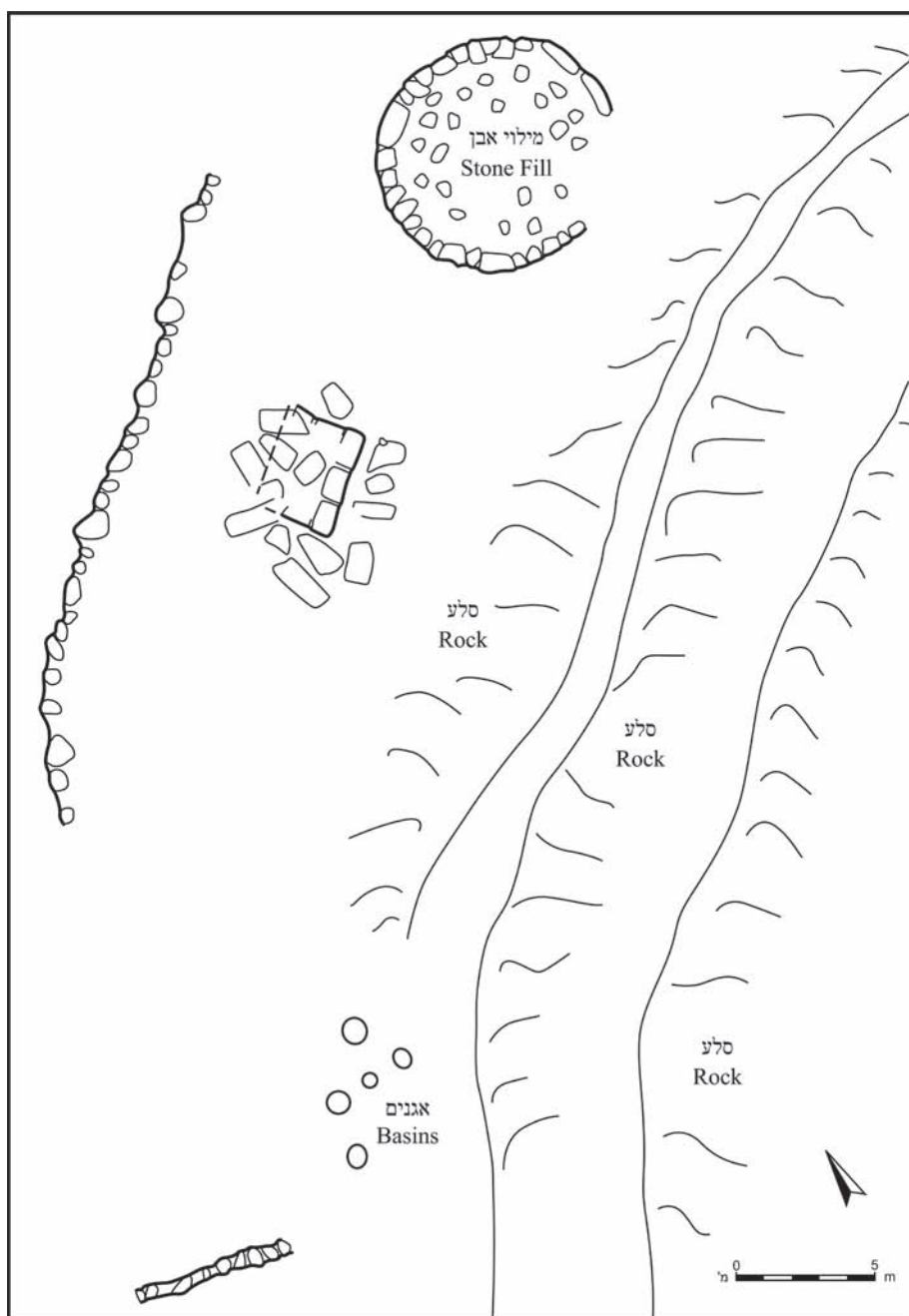
A site on the northern fringe of *Bezeq* Valley (Sahl Ibziq), close to the junction between the Wadi Khashneh road and that of Wadi Shubash.

On the site is a concentration of cisterns and structures, whose lines have been blurred by layers of alluvium and flora. Near the site are some hewn installations (winepress-

es and vats), presumably for processing the agricultural produce. A prominent structure is a round one built of large stones, about 6 m in diameter.

Pottery: LR – 50%; Byz – 50%.

Previous surveys: This is possibly site no. 49 of Gophna and Porath, 1972, although the grid location is inaccurate.



114. Plan of the central part of es-Sahl (A). 2006.

Site 41: 18 – 19/68/1

Ras es-Salmeh

Israel grid: 1864 1981

UTM grid: 7243 5848

Elevation: 713 m a.s.l., 180 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: medium-sized ruin

Area: 6 dunams (1.5 acres)

Topography: high summit

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 10 km distant

Nearest road: Far'ah – Qabatiyeh junction (B5), 3 km distant

Visibility: 8

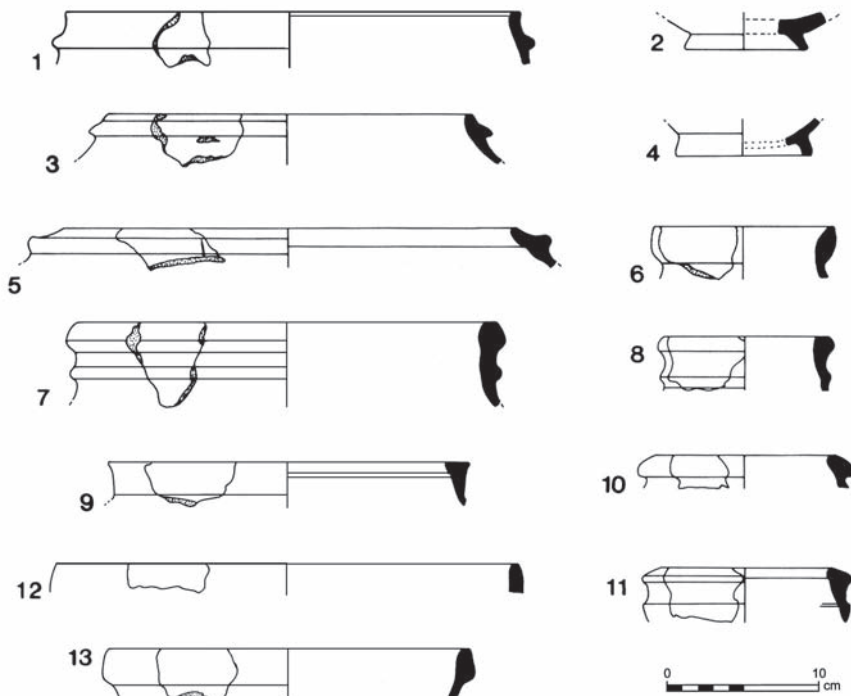
Oct. 22, 1980; 38 shards and two flint tools

* * *

A site on the high, central summit of Ras es-Salmeh, between the valleys Zebabdeh and *Bezeq* (Sahl Ibziq). There is a fine view from here of

these valleys, Mt. Ebal and Hureish Ridge, and the desert fringes.

Along the western side a 50-m-



115. Shards from Ras es-Salmeh, all from IrA IC and IrA II: 1,3. CP, dk; 2. Jug, br; 4. Jug, br; 5. CP, dk br; 6. Jar, yel; 7. Crater, dk br; 8. Early 'ridged' jar, dk br; 9, 12-13. Craters, br; 10-11. Jars, gray.

long wall of large stones was preserved, which served as a defense or supporting wall. Its northern part turns east and partially encloses the site, but a parallel closure on the south was not found. The remains of about ten structures, whose plans have been blurred by cleared stones, are inside the ruin. The highest and most prominent of them, rectangular in shape and measuring about

6x8 m, is next to the western wall; a courtyard is close to it.

Pottery: IrA IC – 50%; IrA II – 50%.

Flint find: Middle Paleolithic; see appendix.

Identification: Probably with *Har-abbat* in the Issachar Allotment (Joshua 19:19); see chapter three.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 42: 18 – 19/88/1

Khirbet Ibziq (Lower)

Israel grid: 1881 1980

UTM grid: 7261 5847

Elevation: 375 m a.s.l., 60 m b.s.a.

Name type: appears on map as historical place

Site type: large ruin

Area: 38 dunams (9.5 acres)

Topography: valley edge, slope and ravine

Rock type: Mount Scopus formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean brown forest soil; quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 45

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Salhab – Beth Shean junction (B7), passes by site

Visibility: 3

Dec. 16, 1982; 50 shards

A large site 1 km northeast of Kh. Ibziq (Upper), located on the slope descending into *Bezeq* Valley (Sahl Ibziq) and close to the ancient Shechem – Beth Shean road. The site extends over two large ridges descending east from the Ras es-Salmeh range, with a ravine separating them.

The remains of many structures built of large, hewn stones, were found *in situ*. In addition, there are

about 70 burial caves, mostly containing a hewn opening, vault and internal building. Many cisterns were also found, as well as the remains of a Roman road nearby. The settlement of Kh. Ibziq (Upper) apparently reached this site during the Byzantine Period.

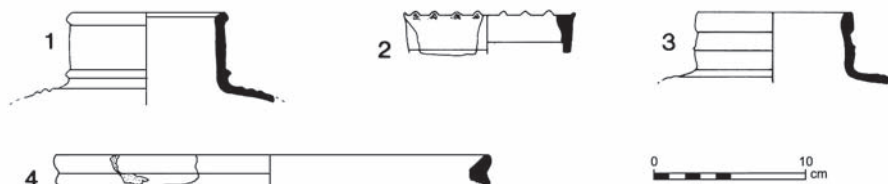
Zori and Eitam, who visited here separately, found hewn winepresses in the site. On the walls of a winepress and a pressing platform the

names *Pardus*, *Josephus* and *Nahum*, Jews or Samaritan names, were engraved in Greek. On another winepress appears the carving: P+OC+A.

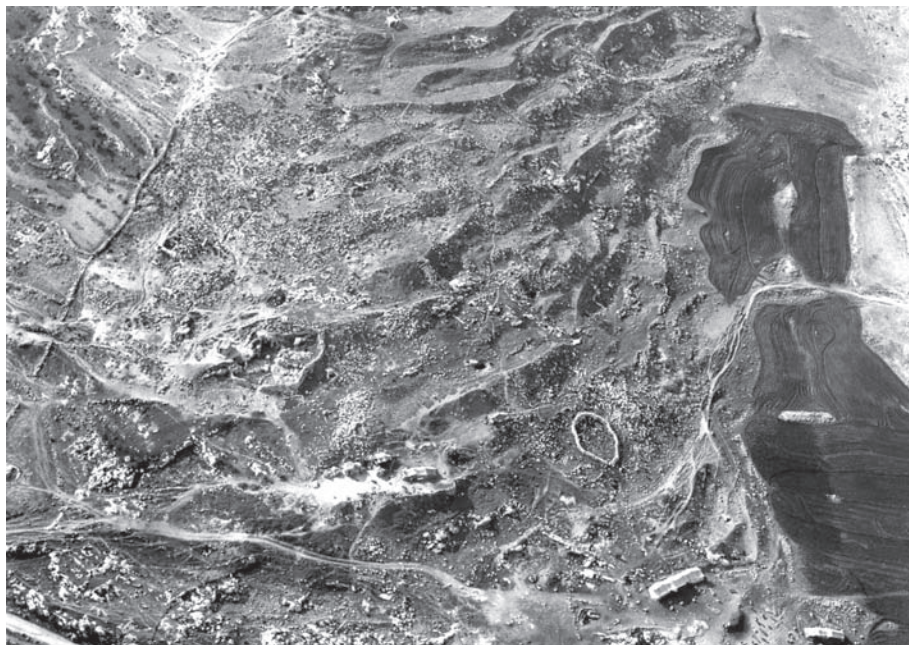
Pottery: Byz – 80%; EM – 20%.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 52; Zori 1977, no. 51.

Bibliography: Onomasticon no. 256; SWP II, 231; Zori 1971; 1977, 36.



116. Shards from Kh. Ibziq – Lower: 1,3. Jars, dk, Byz; 2. Jar, yel, EM; 4. Crater, yel, EM.



117. Aerial photo of the large town from the Byzantine and Early Moslem Periods at Kh. Ibziq (Lower), looking west. The site is between the plowed ravine at right and the ravine at left with the stone wall built along it. Note the remains of the ancient structures, the new Bedouin courtyards and the road to Sahl Ibziq at bottom left.

Winter 1993.



118. The Greek engraving on the winepress at Kh. Ibziq (Lower). The names of three Jews or Samaritans are carved on the rock. Spring 1994.



Site 43: 18 – 19/97/1

el-Quleh

Israel grid: 1893 1979

UTM grid: 7272 5848

Elevation: 399 m a.s.l., 100 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient but does not appear on map

Site type: fortress

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: high summit

Rock type: Mount Scopus formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Salhab – Beth Shean junction (B7), 1 km distant

Visibility: 9

Mar. 24, 1982; 4 shards

A site on a high, isolated hilltop southeast of Sahl Ibziq. To the east is Wadi Khashneh and to the west is the Neapolis – Scythopolis Roman road.

On the summit of the hill is a large pile (about 40 m in diameter) of collapsed, hewn building stones. The place was apparently destroyed by an earthquake. Most of the

building stones, the edges cut in the Hellenistic-Herodian style, are very large (40x60x120 cm in size). Doorpost stones and other hewn stones were also found. West of the structure is a cistern, and about 50 m west of it a stone quarry containing a cave with a convex opening were found. Very few shards were collected at the site.

Gophna and Porath describe “A fort on a high hill, commanding

the road from *Bezeq* to Beth-Shean Valley. There is a large stone-pile 15X15 m in size, with ashlar and edge cutting”. The fortress is apparently related to the Neapolis – Scythopolis Road during the Hellenistic and Early Roman periods. The paucity of pottery suggests that the place was scarcely in use.

Pottery: Hel (?) – 100%.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 53.



119. A view of the fortress at el-Quleh, looking east. The arrow marks the remains on the summit to the right of *Bezeq* Valley (Sahl Ibziq). The slopes of 'Iraq el-Hamam, shown in the background at left, descend into the valley. Winter 1982.



120. The ruins of the Hellenistic Period fortress at el-Quleh. Note the large stones with their hewn edges. Standing – Nivi Mirkam. 1982.



Site 44: 18 – 19/77/1

Khirbet Ibziq (Upper), on SWP map: Kh. Ibzik

Israel grid: 1878 1971

UTM grid: 7255 5838

Elevation: 435 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: appears on map as historical site

Site type: tell and large ruin

Area: 32 dunams (8 acres)

Topography: ridge edge, slope and ravine

Rock type: Mount Scopus formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean

brown forest soil; quality: 5

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 45

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 7 km distant

Nearest road: Salhab – Beth Shean junction (B7), passes by site

Visibility: 4

Dec. 16, 1982; Jan. 10, 1987; Nov.

1988; 102 shards

A large ruin on a slope descending from Ras es-Salmeh into *Bezeq* Valley (Sahl Ibziq). Nearby is a built

pass (*naqb*), between Ras es-Salmeh and Ras Mubarah. From the site there is a view of Taiyasir and the

Upper Wadi Malih.

A sheikh's-tomb, that of Nebi Hizqin, is on the upper part of the ruin, with several houses, the seasonal dwellings of families from Tubas, nearby. These people have made secondary use of the caves, including courtyards, as dwellings. There are also remains of numerous walls, cisterns, quarried places, and a few architectural elements (door-posts and lintels). On the eastern slope there are large areas of plundering. Most of the ancient shards (prior to the Roman Period) were found at the bottom of the slope. Beside the modern road. A paved Roman road runs east of the site.

Pottery: IrA II – 5%; IrA III – 2%; Per – 3%; LR – 20%; Byz – 30%; EM – 10%; MA – 30%.

Special find: Fragment of a bowl with wedge decoration.

Coin finds: Eight, Late Roman to Modern Periods, and see appendix.

Ashtory Haparhi wrote of this site in the 14th century: "From Beth Shean leave the eastern prairie and walk about one hour and ascend, facing south, and after two hours you find *Bezeq* and it is called Ibziq." In 1830 Joseph Schwartz wrote: "To the south of Beth Shean about two hours to the village of Ibziq which is undoubtedly *Bezeq* that is mentioned [in the Bible]".



121. The Roman-Byzantine Periods town at Kh. Ibziq (Upper), looking west. In the center of the photo (top of the ridge) is the tomb of Nebi Hizqin. Remains of structures are scattered over the slopes, and the road leading left to Zebabdeh Valley is in the foreground. At left are the steep slopes of Ras es-Salmeh. 1987.

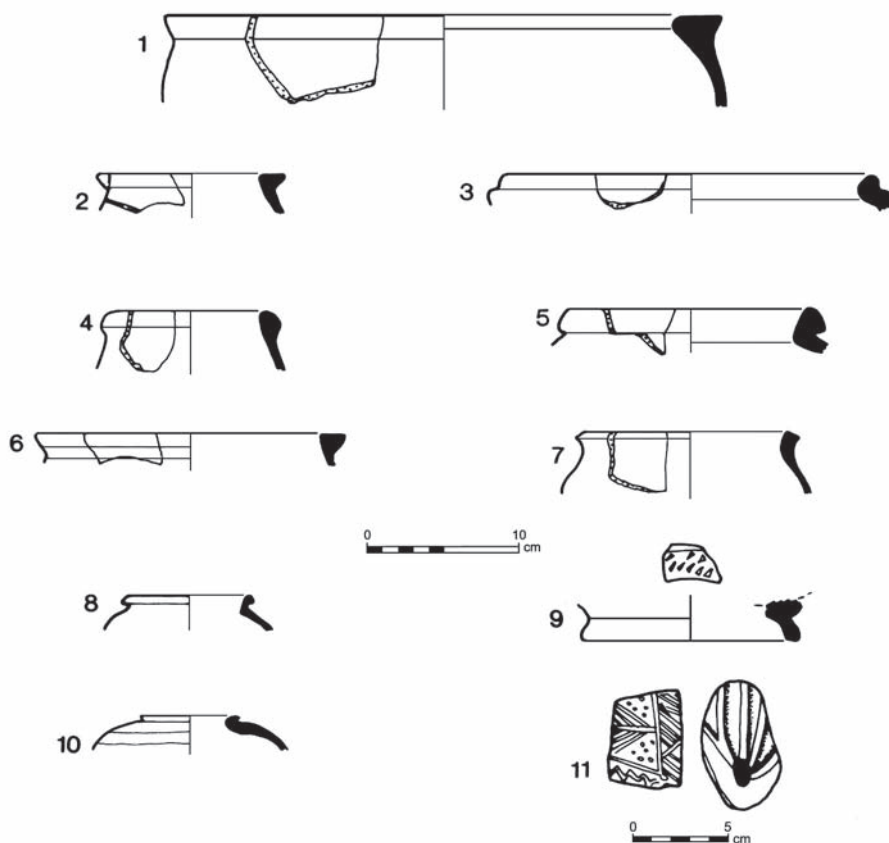
Macalister (1907, 98-99) visited the site in 1906 and saw a convoy of Jews there coming from Tiberias. The British Survey describes "an ancient site with traces of ruins, cisterns and caves, as at Kh. Yerzeh. There is a *kubbeh* (a dome) in the ruins sacred to Sheikh Hazkin apparently Ezekiel." Gophna and Porath repeats the general description.

The identification with Biblical *Bezeq* (Judges 1:4-5) is unfounded

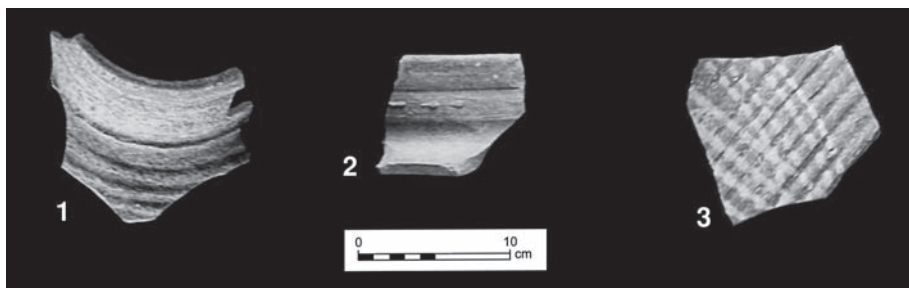
according to the results of the survey; see also Kh. Salhab and chapter three.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath, no. 51; Zori 1977, no. 50.

Bibliography: Eusebius Onomasticon, no. 54; SWP II, 237; Ashtory Haparhi 1887, 287; Schwartz 1845, 194; Conder 1876, 69; 1881, 44; Beyer 1940, 189; Welten 1965, 47; Vilnai 1968, 47; Mazar 1973; Ilan 1973, 371-374; Avi-Yonah 1976, 42; Zertal 1994, 57-59.



122. Pottery from Kh. Ibziq (upper): 1. Crater, br, IrA II; 2. Jar, gray, Per; 3. CP, dk br, IrA II; 4-5. Jars, lt br, LR; 6. Bowl, lt, LR; 7. Jar, br, Byz.; 8. Jug, lt br, ER; 9. Bowl with wedge dec, gray/orange, IrA III; 10. Bowl, lt, ER; 11. Two oil lamps, lt, Byz.



123. Three fragments of jars from the Byzantine and Early Moslem Periods. Note white decoration (no. 3) on black jar.



124. Aerial photo of the Roman-Byzantine Periods town at Kh. Ibziq (upper), looking northwest. The site is on the ridge in the center, with the tomb of Nebi Hizqin at the top. Note the remains of the structures *in situ*. Winter 1993.

CHAPTER SIX

TUBAS VALLEY

LANDSCAPE UNIT 14



A Roman tomb near Taiyasir

From: The second volume of the *Survey of Western Palestine*, p. 245

(drawing by G. Stackford)

Site 45: 18 – 19/74/1

Taiyasir (on SWP map: Taiasir)

Israel grid: 1875 1942

UTM grid: 7255 5809

Elevation: 300 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: appears on map, but not as historical site

Site type: medium sized ruin and Arab village

Area: 10 dunams (2.5 acres)

Topography: ridge edge and valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterranean brown forest soil; quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 30

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Mayatteh, no. 86), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), passes by site

Visibility: 5

Dec. 7, 1980; 32 shards

A small Arab village between Tubas Valley and Upper Wadi Malih. The ancient pass and the new road from the Tubas Valley to the Jordan pass

inside the village.

The ancient core, relatively small in area, is on the elongated ridge



125. The village of Taiyasir, looking north. The road in the center runs from Tubas to the Jordan Valley. The ancient core is in the center of the village, and the hills of Miqwaq and Wadi Taiyasir are at left. Winter 1994.

directed approximately northsouth. There are several ancient, fortified Medieval structures in this core. In the house and terrace walls building stones are interwoven. Most of the shards were scattered on the western slopes.

West of the village is a family grave from the Roman Period, described by Conder and Kitchener and by Guérin. It is 9x9 m in size, built of large, well hewn stones. The opening and doorpost, skillfully carved and decorated with embossed strips, are well preserved. The entrance to the burial chamber is through a small hallway with decorated doorposts. Inside there are niches for the coffins, and next to the structure are two cisterns and more carved stones.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 2%; IrA IA – 2%; ER – 16%; LR – 20%; Byz – 25%; EM – 10%; MA – 15%; Ott – 10%.

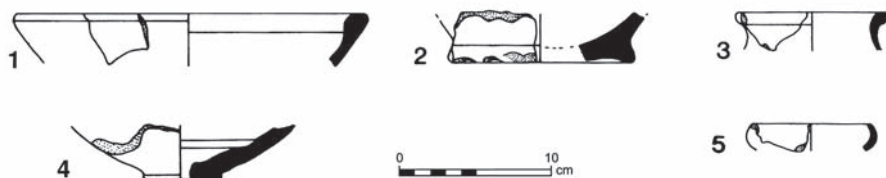
In the Onomasticon the place is defined as “*Asher*, a Manassite city. And today there is a village called thus near the road from Neapolis to Scythopolis in the fifteenth mile

of the king’s road”. The Moslem geographer, el-Muqaddasi (985 C.E.) mentions two postal stations from Beth Shean to Taiyasir and one more toward Shechem. The road, therefore, was used during the Abasside period. In 1596 there were 39 households and nine single people in the village, all Moslems. Guérin described the village and the family grave, and proposed the identification with *Asher*, in accordance with the Onomasticon. Macalister described the village and family grave in detail in 1906. The village was also mentioned with relation to the Roman road Neapolis – Scythopolis. Gophna and Porath found a few Iron Age I shards near the family grave.

Identification: Identified as *Tirzah* by Schwartz (1830) and as *Asher* by Guérin. The findings make either identification difficult, and see chapter three.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 69.

Bibliography: Onomasticon P. 93; Schwartz *Tevu’ot*, 186; Guérin 1969 (IV), 355-357; SWP II, 245-246,



126. Shards from Taiyasir: 1. Crater, br, IrA I; 2. Bowl base, br, IrA I-II; 3. Jar, lt br, Byz; 4. Jug base, yel, MBA II; 5. Small bowl, lt, LR.

288; Thomsen 1917, 72; Beyer 358; Hutteroth and Abd el-Fatah 1940, 189; Marmadji 1951, 103; 1977, 125; Neef 1982, 164. Milik 1966, 524; Ilan 1973, 357-



Site 46: 18 – 19/53/2

Khallet et-Tawileh

Israel grid: 1854 1939
UTM grid: 7233 5807
Elevation: 370 m a.s.l., 25 m b.s.a.
Name type: nearest place
Site type: shard scatter
Area: 1.6 dunams (0.4 acre)
Topography: slope and ravine
Rock type: Judah formation
Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterranean brown forest soil; quality: 6

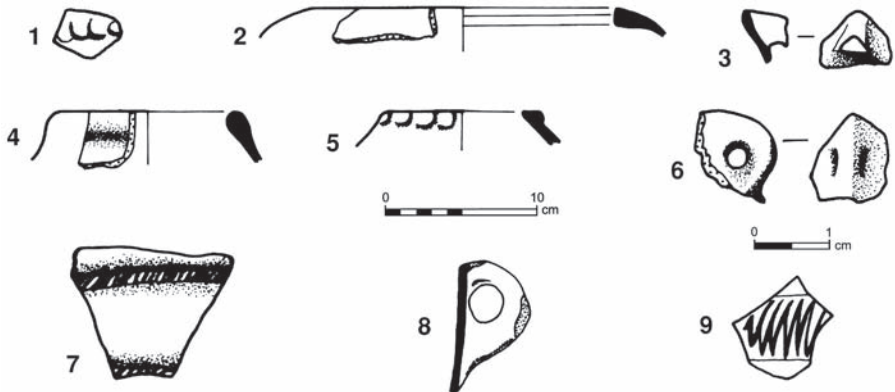
Cultivation: uncultivated and field crops
Cisterns: none
Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 7 km distant
Nearest road: Far‘ah – Qabatiyeh junction (B5), 1.5 km distant
Visibility: 2
Dec. 3, 1980; 26 shards and 22 flint items

A small site in a ravine named Khallet et-Tawileh, a hilly range separating the valleys Tubas and Zebab-deh. Wadi Fuqahah is south of the site, which is about 2 km northeast of Tubas.

A shard scatter was found here, but no structural remains.

Pottery and flint: Chal – 100%; for flint find see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



127. Shards from Khallet et-Tawileh, all Chal: 1, 7, 9. Plastic dec, lt br; 2. HM jar, dk; 4-5. Bowls, rough, br; 3, 6, 8. Loop handles.

Site 47: 18 – 19/53/1

Khirbet Fuqahah (on SWP map: Khurbet es Sumra)

Israel grid: 1850 1933
 UTM grid: 7232 5802
 Elevation: 458 m a.s.l., 60 m a.s.a.
 Name type: ancient but does not appear on map
 Site type: large tell
 Area: 60 dunams (15 acres)
 Topography: ridge edge, valley edge and hilltop
 Rock type: Mount Scopus formation

Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterranean brown forest soil; quality: 8
 Cultivation: field crops and orchards
 Cisterns: 9
 Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Far'ah, no. 85), 7 km distant
 Nearest road: Far'ah – Qabatiyeh (B5), passes by site
 Visibility: 6
 Nov. 9, 1980; 109 shards

* * *

A fortified tell at the edge of a ridge descending into Tubas Valley, 1 km north of the village of that name. This ridge separates the valleys Zebabdeh and Tubas, with a fine view to the latter.

The site consists of two parts:

1. The ancient tell on the upper part is surrounded by a city wall in the east, south and west. It is built of large field stones and 3 m wide in some spots. Inside there are numerous structural remains, piles of cleared stones, caves and quarried places.

2. Below, on the slope, is the somehow later Khirbeh, presum-

ably dated to the Byzantine period and later. This part also contains many walls, cisterns, quarried places and an abundance of shards. In the SWP "ruined walls" are mentioned.

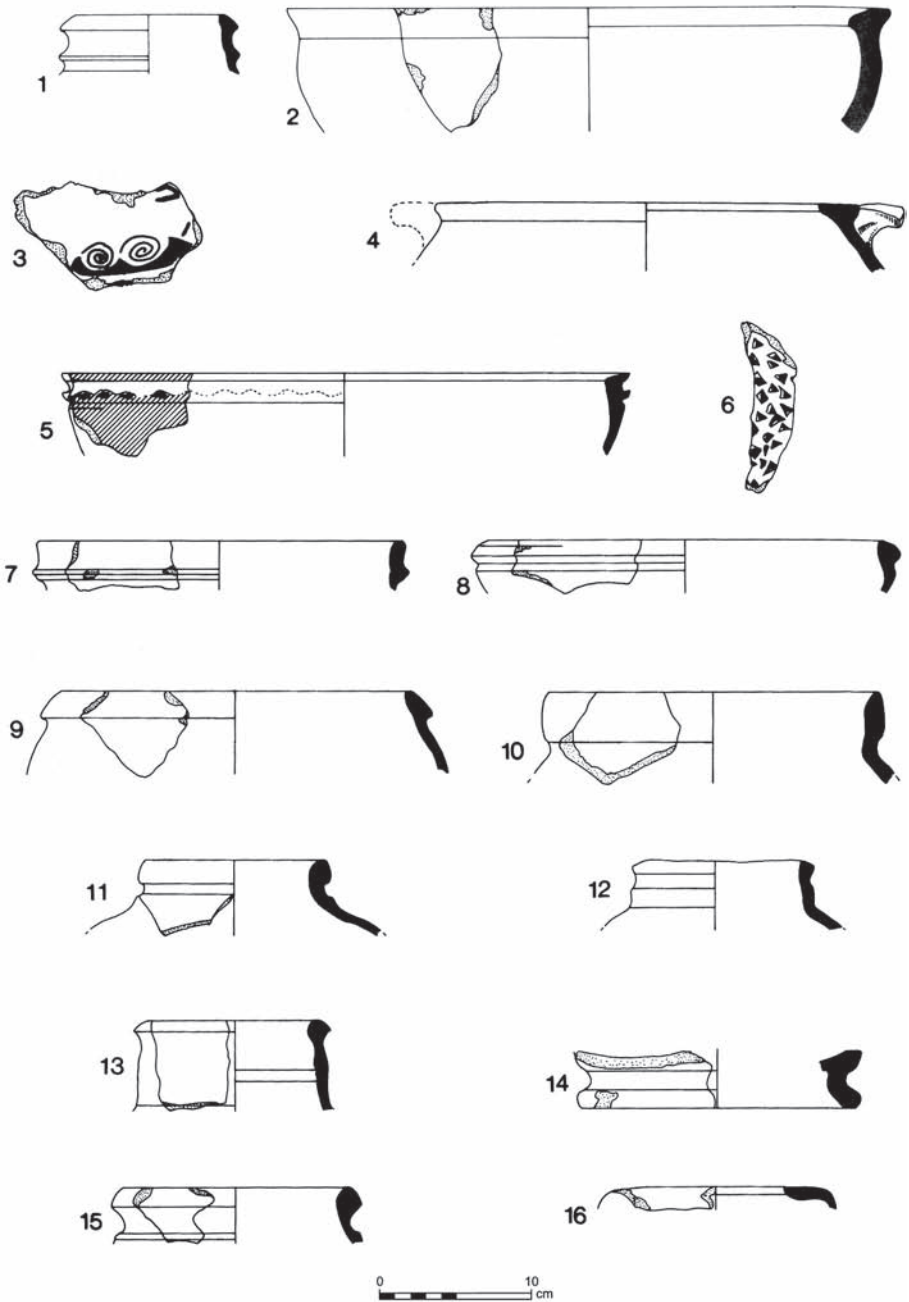
Pottery: IrA IA – 5%; IrA II – 15%; IrA III – 10%; Per – 10%; Hel – 10%; ER – 5%; LR – 5%; Byz – 20%; EM – 10%; MA – 10%.

Special find: Bowl fragments with wedge decoration.

Identification: Possibly Biblical *Thebez* (Judges 9:50 on; II Samuel 11:21); see chapter three.

Previous surveys: none.

Bibliography: SWP II, 240



128. Pottery from Kh. Fuqahah: 7, 10 - IrA I; 1-2, 4, 9, 11-12, 15-16 - IrA II-III; 6 - IrA III; 14 - Per; 8, 13 - ER; 5 - EM; 3 - MA. 1. Ridged jar, gray/orange; 2. Crater, br; 3. Dec bowl, violet on white slip; 4. Crater, br; 5. Bowl, red slip; 6. 'Wedge' dec on bowl, gray/orange; 7. CP, dk; 8. Bowl, lt br; 9. Crater, dk br; 10. Pythos, dk; 11-12. Jars, br; 13. Jar, pk; 14. Bowl base, yel; 15. Jar, dk br; 16. HM jar, lt br.

Site 48: 18 – 19/63/2

el-Miqwaq (B)

Israel grid: 1862 1934

UTM grid: 7243 5803

Elevation: 325 m a.s.l., 25 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 5 dunams (1.25 acres)

Topography: slope and plateau

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterra-

nean brown forest soil; quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 3

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Far'ah, no. 85), 6 km distant

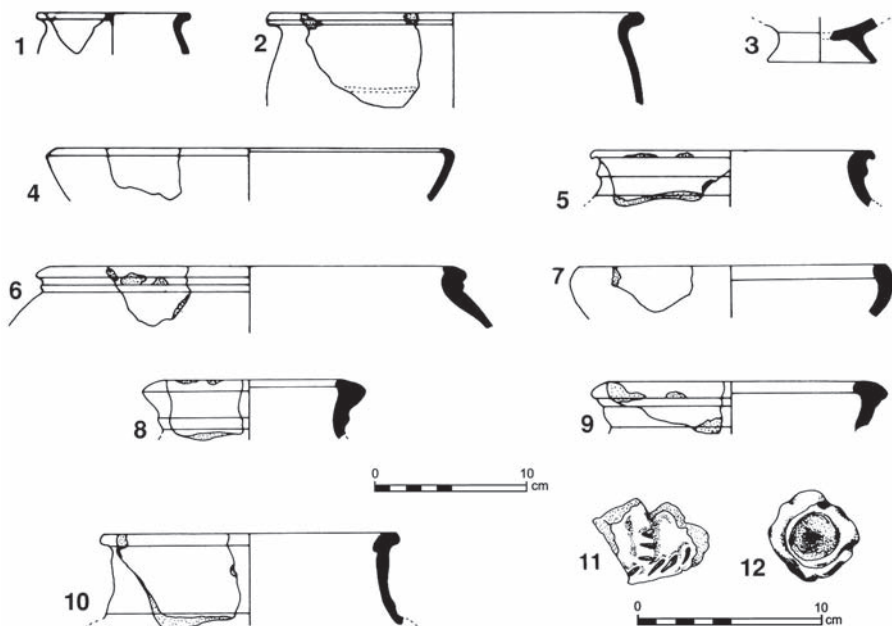
Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 1 km distant

Visibility: 3

Dec. 3, 1980; 40 shards.

An enclosure on the northwestern slope of el-Miqwaq range, half way between the villages of Tubas and Taiyasir. To its north flows Wadi Hamed, and Kh. Fuqahah is situated 1 km to the west.

The site is an elliptical shaped enclosure, whose axis is directed northeast – southwest. It is surrounded by a wall of a double row of stones, standing in upright position one course high. Inside are several



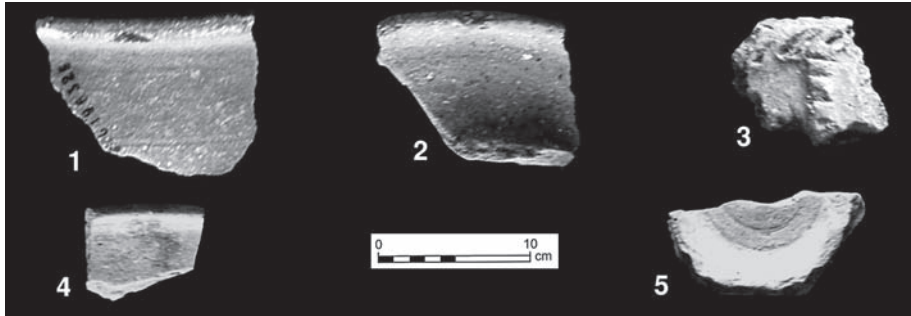
129. Pottery from el-Miqwaq (B): nos. 3-4, 7 - LBA; the rest from MBA IIB: 1, 3. Carinated bowls, lt; 2. Bowl, yel; 4. Bowl, whitish; 5, 8-10. Jars, pinkish; 6. Crater, br; 7. Bowl, br; 11-12. Plastic dec.

walls and piles of stones, apparently covering structures. There are also few quarried places and caves. West of the enclosure, whose entrance was not found, is a round structure with Middle Bronze Age II shards

around. To its north and east are burial caves with triangular cut openings and quarried stairs.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 5%; LBA I – 50%.

Previous surveys: none.



130. Shards from el-Miqwaq (B), all from MBA II.



Site 49: 18 – 19/63/1

el-Miqwaq (A)

Israel grid: 1869 1936

UTM grid: 7250 5803

Elevation: 340 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 1.5 dunams (0.4 acre)

Topography: slope, plateau and ravine

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterra-

nean brown forest soil; quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Far'ah, no. 85), 7 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), passes by site

Visibility: 4

Nov. 30, 1980; 28 shards.

A small site in a little ravine in the southeastern part of the Miqwaq range, isolated from its surroundings by two tributaries of Wadi Tai-yasir. It is about 700 m southwest of the center of the village of Tai-

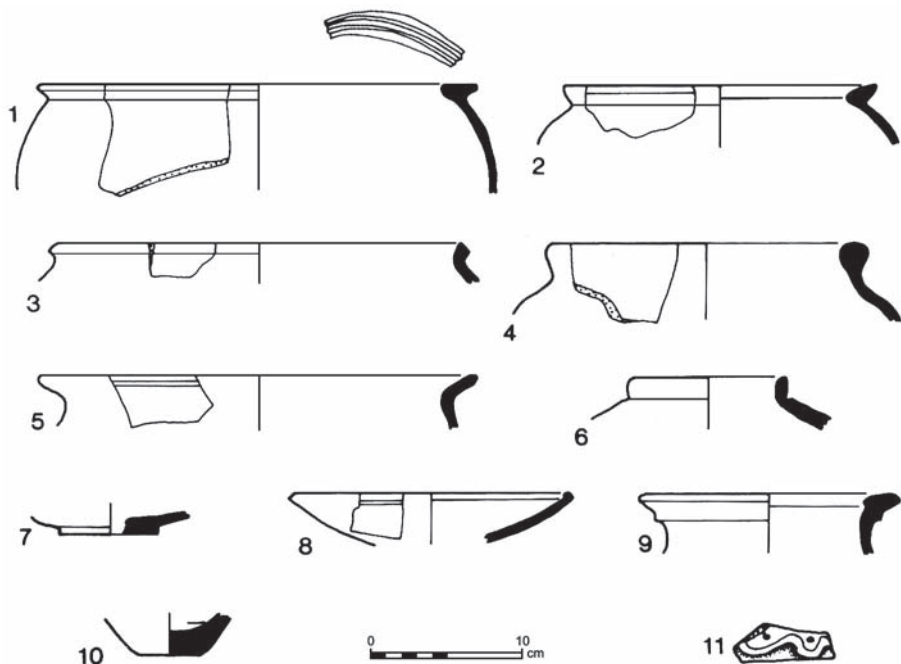
yasir, with a view to the village, Tubas Valley and the ascent of Wadi Malih.

The remains of several buildings, apparently from the Middle Bronze Age, are located upon several ter-

paces in the ravine. The plans are obscured by piles of stones, and the amount of shards is considerable.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



131. Shards from el-Miqwaq (A), all from MBA IIB: 1-2. Craters, br; 3. CP, lt br; 4. Jar, br; 5. Bowl, lt; 6-7. Jar and bowl base, yel; 8. Bowl, lt; 9. Jar, pinkish; 10. Jug base, br; 11. Dec of indented CP, dk.



Site 50: 18 – 19/52/1

ej-Jelameh

Israel grid: 1855 1926

UTM grid: 7237 5794

Elevation: 330 m a.s.l., 8 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: fortified tell and structure

Area: 4.8 dunams (1.2 acres)

Topography: hilltop and valley

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 8

Cultivation: field crops and orchards

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 1 km distant

Visibility: 5

Nov. 30, 1980; 51 shards

A small tell on a natural hill in the north of Tubas Valley, about 700 m northeast of the village of Tubas.

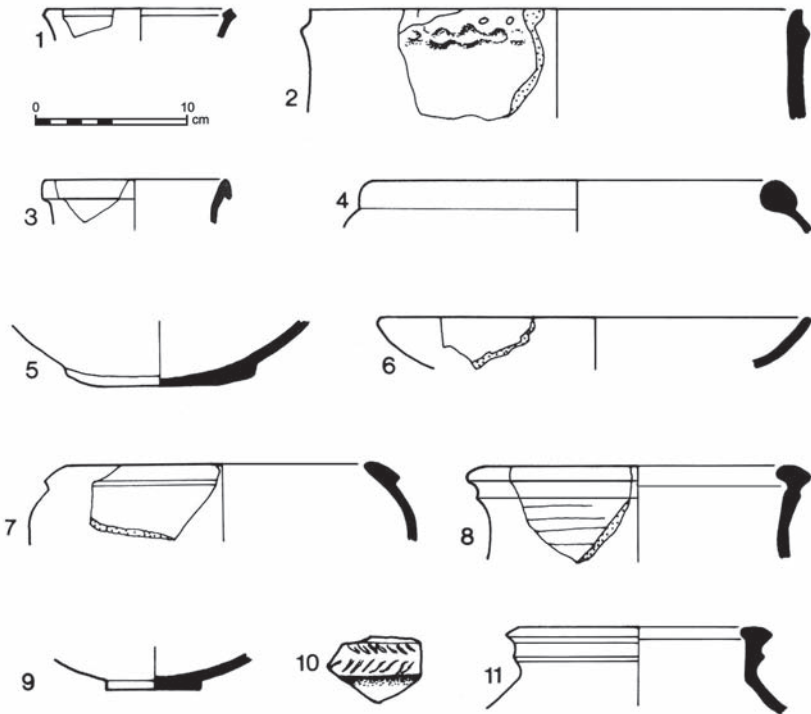
From the top of the tell, where an abandoned modern structure now stands, moderate slopes descend to the east and south. Along the eastern slope there is an artificial rampart, with many shards around. This was probably part of the fortification. Rocky areas with cisterns and hewn installations are on the southern slope. The shard

scatter suggests that the ancient settlement (Middle Bronze Age) covered the south and east of the hill. Later, during the Byzantine Period, it spread to the hilltop around the new structure.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 90%; Byz – 10%.

Special find: A jar handle with blurred Middle Bronze Age II scarab seal stamp.

Previous finds: none.



132. Pottery from ej-Jelameh, all from MBA IIB; 1. Jug, yel; 2, 4. CP, indented and folded, dk; 3. Jar, yel; 5. Bowl base, yel; 6. Open bowl, lt; 7. Crater, yel; 8, 11. Jars, pinkish; 9. Bowl base, br; 10. "Fishbone" dec on jar.

Site 51: 18 – 19/62/1

el-Murhan

Israel grid: 1864 1928
 UTM grid: 7245 5795
 Elevation: 409 m a.s.l., 25 m a.s.a.
 Name type: nearest place
 Site type: small ruin and installations
 Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)
 Topography: hilltop and plateau
 Rock type: Judah formation
 Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterranean brown forest soil; quality: 4

Cultivation: uncultivated and field crops
 Cisterns: 3
 Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 6 km distant
 Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), passes by site
 Visibility: 6
 Nov. 30, 1980; 20 shards

* * *

A small site on a hilltop on the southern edge of el-Miqwaq range, between the villages of Tubas and Taiyasir.

There are stone foundations of two structures, with hewn installations (winepresses and other wine-producing devices) to their east. Northeast of them are a large cistern and a burial cave with three hewn steps.

The site contains structures, an industrial area and a concentration of installations for wine production; it is not clear whether an agricultural farm stood on the site.

This may be Kh. Handuq of the SWP map.

Pottery: Byz – 20%; EM – 20%; MA – 60%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 52: 18 – 19/42/1

Tubas (also on SWP map)

Israel grid: 1849 1922
 UTM grid: 7228 5791
 Elevation: 390 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.
 Name type: on map, but not as historical site.
 Site type: large Arab village
 Area: 50 dunams (12.5 acres)
 Topography: valley edge and ridge
 Rock type: Mount Scopus formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 7
 Cultivation: none
 Cisterns: about 100
 Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 4 km distant
 Nearest road: Far‘ah – Qabatiyeh (B5), passes by site
 Visibility: 5
 Visits to edges of village: 1981, 1985

A very large village (small town) on the western edge of Tubas Valley.

Security conditions prevented a full survey in the village, and only its edges were surveyed. In 1971 a hewn tomb was discovered west of the village, with a burial chamber and five niches. It was found decorated by painted stripes, with 22 pottery vessels from the 9th-8th centuries BCE (Iron Age II) as burial gifts. There is a high probability that an Iron Age site was somewhere in the village.

Pottery: LR – 10%; Byz – 30%; EM – 10%; MA – 30%; Ott – 10%;

Mod – 10%.

In the Middle Ages the place was known as *Thopas*, mentioned in various sources as a place on the road from Shechem to Beth Shean. In 1596 there were 41 households and 16 single individuals in the town, all Moslems. Ashtory Haparhi writes, “Go on, always walking southward, and in about an hour you will find *Thebez* which is called Tubas”. Schwartz (1830) writes, “*Thebez*: to the northeast of Shechem about five hours is the village of Tubas”. The place was partially destroyed by the earthquake of 1837. Guérin found a small town with cave dwellings



133. The center of the village of Tubas, bird's eye view, looking northeast. The ancient tell, containing a mosque, is left of center. The location of the Iron Age site is uncertain. 1993.

and many hewn tombs. The British Surveyors found a village divided into quarters, with a sheikh heading each one, and several Christians.

Identification: Possibly *Thebez* (by most of the explorers). It seems, though, preferable to identify *Thebez* at Kh. 'Eynun or Kh. Fuqahah, both nearby; see chapter three.

Previous surveys: none.

Bibliography: Onomasticon, p. 165; Ashtory Haparhi *Kaphtor va-Ferah*, 287; Schwartz *Tevu'ot*, 188; Robinson 1857, 400; Guérin 1969 (IV), 357-359; SWP II, 247; Sejourne 1895, 617; Beyer 1940, 172, 189, 202; Milik 1966, 522-530; *Archaeological News* 38 (1971) 13-14, Hutteroth and Abd el-Fatah 1977, 125; Neef 1982, 164.



Site 53: 18 – 19/71/1

Khallet Qatus

Israel grid: 1872 1918

UTM grid: 7251 7864

Elevation: 420 m a.s.l., 5 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 4 dunams (1 acre)

Topography: valley edge, ridge and ravine

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and allurium;

quality: 8

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Far'ah, no. 85), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 1 km distant

Visibility: 3

Nov. 13, 1980; 33 shards

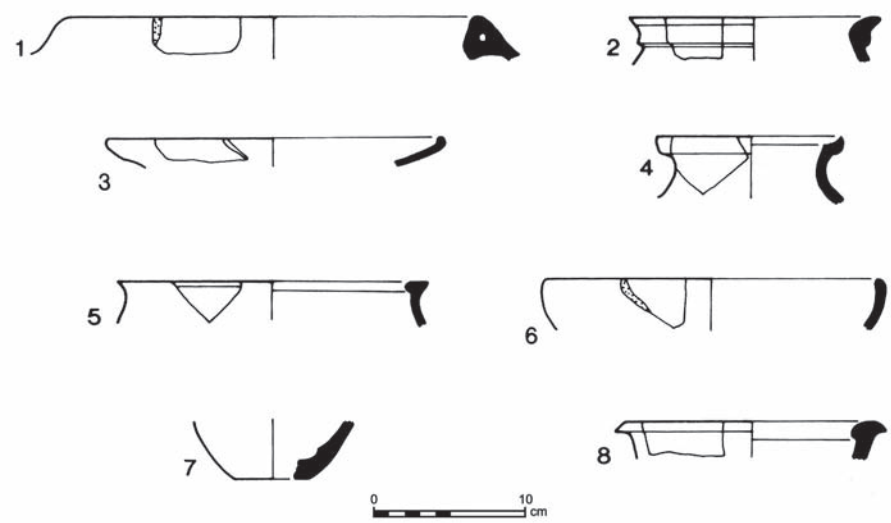
A site on the low, eastern fringes of Tubas Valley, north of Khallet Qatus. From the place there is a fine view of Tubas Valley, and nearby a dirt road ascends to the top of Ras Jadir.

The center of the site, upon three built terraces, is a structure of megalithic stones, 5x6 m in size. A neighboring structure contains three walls of smaller stones with a closure wall. Nearby is a

large, hewn cave whose roof has collapsed. Similar structures, less well preserved, were found to the west of the central structure. To the north of the site, about 200 m away, are three round and square structures, also built of megalithic stones. There are also numerous caves in the area.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



134. Pottery from Khallet Qatus, all from MBA II: 1. Folded CP, dk; 2. Jar, pinkish; 3. Bowl, lt; 4. Jar, lt br; 5. Bowl, br; 6. Bowl, yel; 7. Jug base, lt br; 8. Jar, gray.



135. The Roman road from Tubas Valley to the Buqei'ah, looking south. At left are the slopes of Khallet Qatus. 1986.

Site 54: 18 – 19/71/2

es-Skhrah

Israel grid: 1875 1912

UTM grid: 7255 5784

Elevation: 420 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: large ruin

Area: 10 dunams (2.5 acres)

Topography: valley edge, slope and valley

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;

quality: 8

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Far'ah, no. 85), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Taiyasir – Buqe'ah junction (C19), passes by site

Visibility: 4

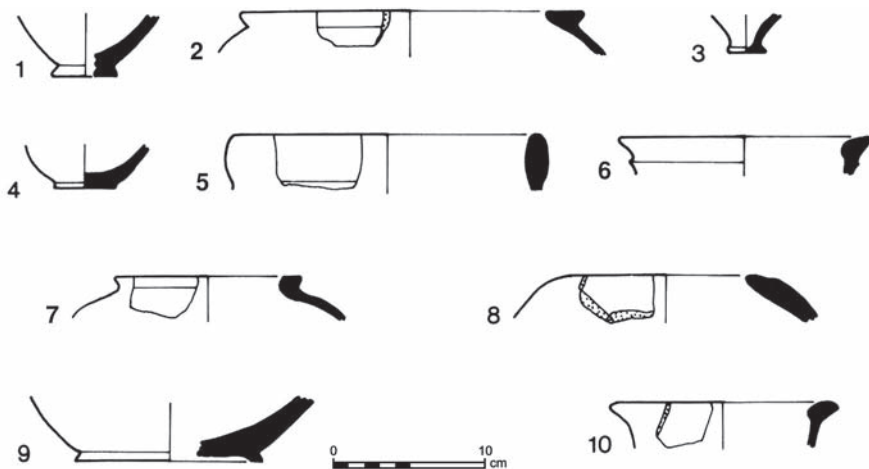
Nov. 13, 1980, 44 shards

* * *

A large site on the eastern fringes of Tubas Valley, between Khallet Qatus and Khallet Diyabil. From the site, Tubas Valley and the mountains Yasid and Ebal are clearly visible.

The site extends over a long, narrow strip aligned southeast – northwest. It includes two or three com-

plete structures and many walls, built of especially large (*megalithic*) stones that signify remains of buildings. The southernmost of the complete ones is a round structure, and the northernmost is a square one. The present dispersion of walls suggests that the entire area was once covered by similar structures, built



136. Potshards from es-Skhrah, no. 1, 3, 5, 9 – IrA I; the rest – MBA II: 1. Jug, br; 2. Crater, yel; 3. Juglet, br; 4. Bowl, gray; 5. Pythos, dk; 6. Jar, br; 7. Bowl, yel; 8. HM jar, lt; 9. Bowl, yel; 10. Jar, pinkish.

at considerable distances from each other. A significant shard scatter is on the surface.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 80%; IrA IA – 20%.

Previous surveys: none.



137. The Tubas Valley from the north. At right is the village of Tubas and at left is the range of Ras Jadir.



Site 55: 18 – 19/60/1

Khirbet ed-Der

(also on SWP map; Guérin writes Kh. Sinia)

Israel grid: 1865 1906

UTM grid: 7246 5774

Elevation: 370 m a.s.l., 5 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map as historical place

Site type: medium sized ruin

Area: 6 dunams (1.5 acres)

Topography: hilltop and valley

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 7

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 30

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far’ah, no. 85), 5 km distant

Nearest road: Far’ah – Qabatiyeh (B5), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 5

Nov. 16, 1980; Mar. 14, 1987; 122 shards and seven flint items

A site on the southeastern fringes of Tubas Valley, 2 km from the village of Tubas. South of it is a deep wadi and a dirt road, coming from the north and leading to the Buqe'ah, passes alongside.

The place is easily approached from the west, north and east. Along the edge of the slope an earthen rampart is located, possibly an ancient fortification. Above and north of it are a few remnants of walls and many shards. Remains of a later settlement, from the Hellenistic Period onwards, are in the northern and eastern parts of the site. Walls, quarried places, cisterns, and various hewn installations, including troughs for watering flocks, are also found in the area.

Pottery: MBA II – 20%; LBA I – 10%; LBA II – 5%; LBA III – 15%; IrA IA – 30%; Hel – 3%; ER – 2%; LR – 5%; Byz – 5%; MA – 5%.

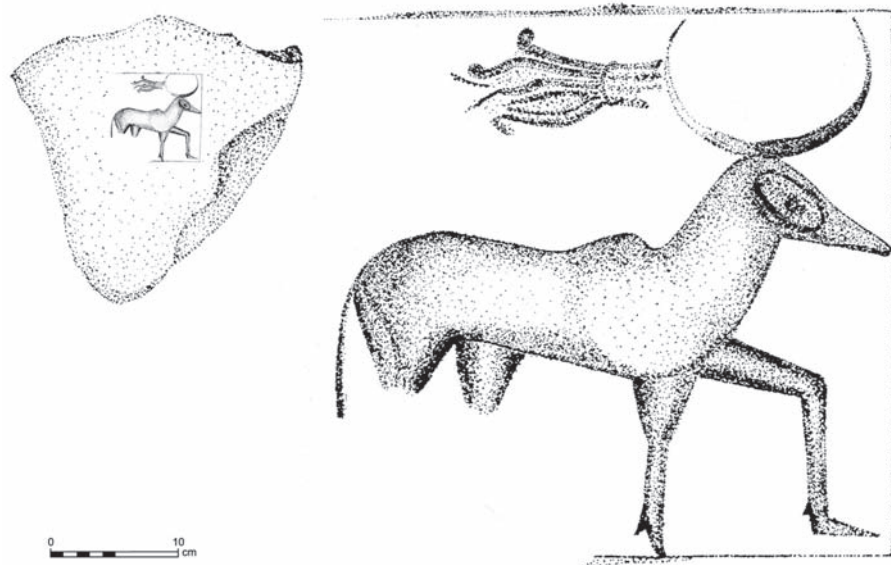
Flint: IrA (most of the finds), and see appendix.

Special find: Seal impression of a bull facing right within square frame, and two rosette prints on jar handles.

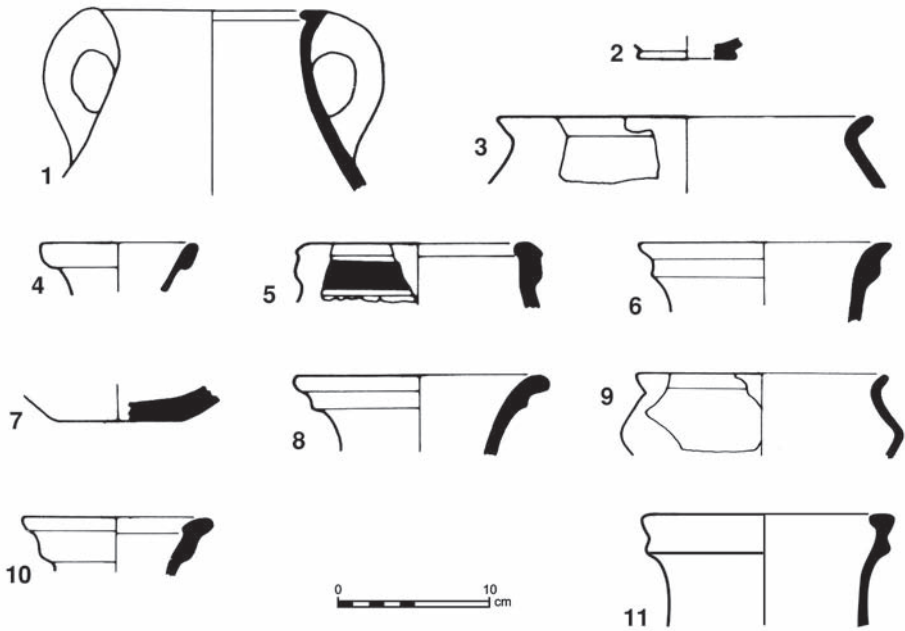
Guérin visited the site, named by him Kharbet Sinia, on May 4, 1870. He found “cisterns and ancient cellars”, as well as many animal pens. The SWP describes “heaps of stones and foundations”.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 97.

Bibliography: Guérin 1969 (IV), 361; SWP II, 236.



138. Seal imprint of animal facing right, on jar handle, dk ware (Drawing: Fany Cohn).



139. Pottery from Kh. ed-Der: nos. 2, 5, 7, 9-10 – MBA II; the rest – IrA I (“Eynun family”): 1. Jar, yel; 2. Bowl base, yel; 3. Crater, yel; 4. Jar, lt; 5. Jar, pk, dec, MBA II (?); 6. Jar, lt; 7. Bowl base, br; 8. Jar, bl; 9. Bowl, yel; 10. Jar, yel; 11. Jar, gray.



Site 56: 18 – 19/80/1

Khallet Abu Slah

Israel grid: 1884 1902

UTM grid: 7264 5772

Elevation: 460 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: valley edge and slope

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 8

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Taiyasir – Buqei‘ah junction (C19), passes by site

Visibility: 4

Nov. 20, 1980; 39 shards

A small site on the low, southeastern fringes of Tubas Valley, with a view of the valley and of Jebel Tam-

mun.

The ruin, extending over two new terraces, is composed of two

sections:

In the northwest, next to Khallet Diyabil, is an area of 0.5 dunam (0.125 acre) with many shards from the Byzantine Period.

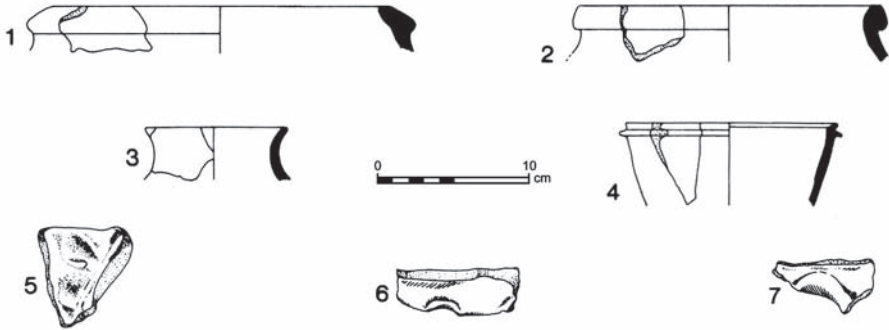
In the central part are many shards from Middle Bronze Age I,

with no structural remains.

This is one of the “strip sites”, typical of the Tubas Valley in the Middle Bronze Age I and II.

Pottery: MBA I – 50%; Byz – 50%.

Previous surveys: none.



140. Pottery from Khallet Abu Slah: nos. 3, 5-7 – MBA I; the rest – Byz: 1-2. Craters, br; 3. Jar, yel; 4. Bowl, br; 5-7. Dec and folded ledge handles, lt.



Site 57: 18 – 19/60/2

‘Iraq Rajjah

Israel grid: 1866 1900

UTM grid: 7248 5767

Elevation: 400 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin and structure

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: valley edge and hilltop

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 4 km distant

Nearest road: Taiyasir - Buqei‘ah junction (C19), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 4

Nov. 23, 1980; 48 shards

A small site on a low hillock on the ‘Eynun Range, 1 km west of Kh. ‘Eynun and 2 km southeast of the village of Tubas.

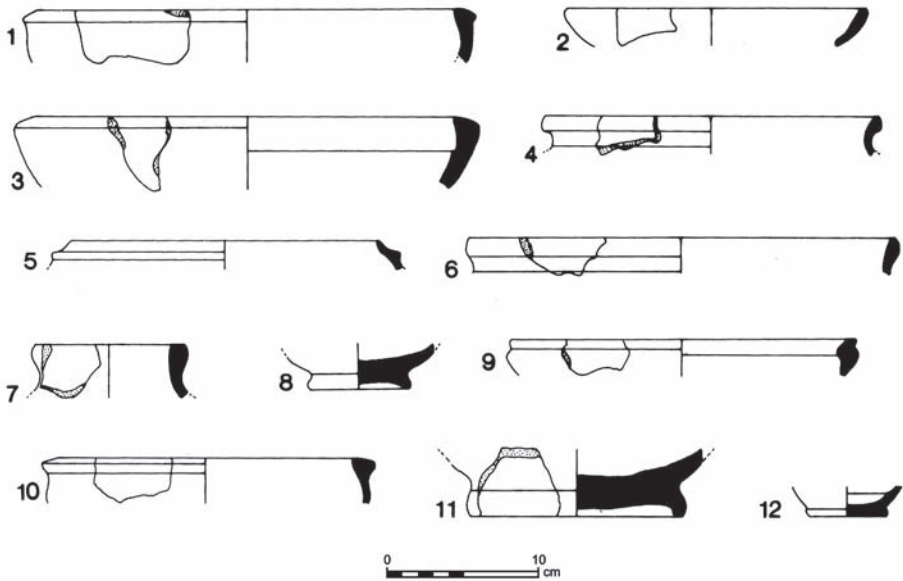
A small structure, about 2x4 m in size, is on the hilltop. It is a stage like structure built of large stones, with a similar one, dismantled, in

the vicinity. On the northern slope are two more walls *in situ*, presumably belonging to the site. A double winepress with a square crushing platform is to the northeast, with

another round platform nearby.

Pottery: IrA IA (“Eynun family”) – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



141. Pottery from ‘Iraq Rajjah, all from IrA I (“Eynun family”): 1-3. Bowls, br; 4-6. CP, dk br (no. 5 – IrA IB); 7-8. Jugs, br; 9-11. Craters, br; 12. Jug, lt.



Site 58: 18 – 19/79/1

Khirbet ‘Eynun (on SWP map and Guérin: Kh. ‘Ainoun)

Israel grid: 1875 1898

UTM grid: 7256 5766

Elevation: 439 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map as historical site

Site type: tell and large ruin

Area: 32 dunams (8 acres)

Topography: hilltop and valley

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;
quality: 8

Cultivation: uncultivated and orchards

Cisterns: 30

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 5 km distant

Nearest road: Taiyasir – Buqei‘ah junction (C19), 0.5 km distant

Visibility: 6

Nov. 16, 1980; Dec. 3, 1980; 1984; 1986; more visits; 198 shards.

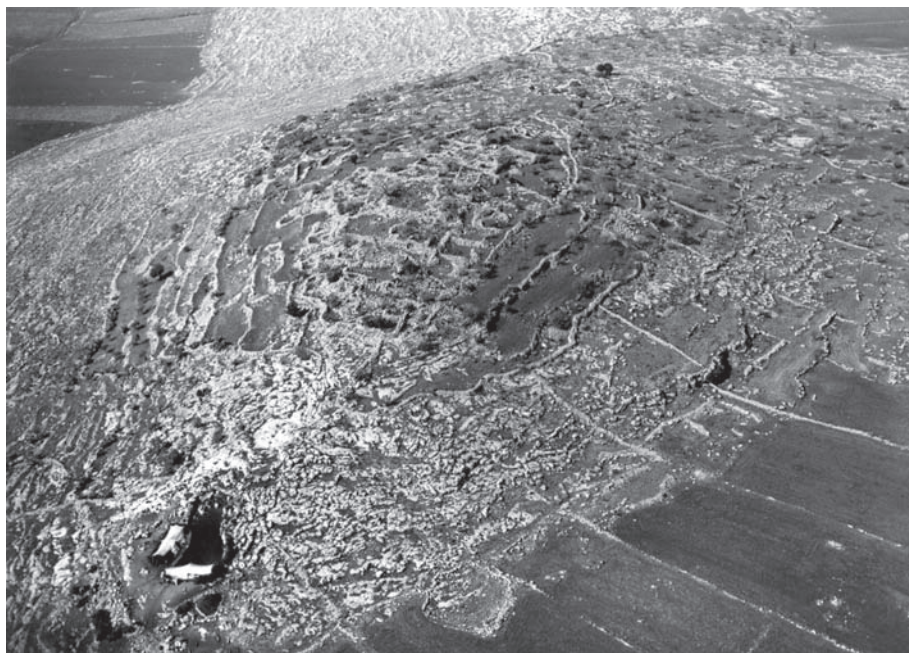
A tell on a prominent hilltop, in the southeastern fringes of Tubas Valley (Sahl ed-Der) and 3.5 km southeast of Tubas.

The two ancient terebinth trees, which grow on the summit, are in the center of the later settlement (Byzantine Period and onward) whose area is relatively small (6-8 dunams, or 1.5-2 acres). There are structures here, with quarried places and many courtyards and alleys. The ancient settlement is much larger in area, with a fortification-wall of big boulders dating most probably to Iron Age I. This wall is located at the bottom of the tell's slope.

On the west side of the wall, remnants of a possible entrance were detected. The northern and southern slopes, within the city-wall, are crowded with building remains and pottery. Around the site and along the bottom of the hill, six circles of standing monoliths, 20-40 m in diameter each, were found. West of the tell is a winepress with a hewn vat and a round, crushing stone.

The place was undoubtedly a central site during Iron Age I (Early Israelite Settlement period), with a special 'family' of pottery found, and see chapter on ceramics.

Pottery: IrA IA – ("Eynun family") – 70%; IrA II – 5%; Byz – 10%;



142. Bird's eye view of Kh. 'Eynun, looking west. On top of the tell the later settlement is visible, and the Iron Age remains are on the slopes. At the bottom some circles can be seen. In the far background are the ravines descending into Wadi Sabun. 1993.

EM – 5%; MA – 10%.

Special finds: Rosette imprints; indented decorations of all sorts; ‘faces’ on jug and jar handles; fragment of Astrate figurine; tip of clay penis.

Guérin visited here on May 4, 1870, describes: “Here was once a large village, now completely overthrown. A great number of rock-cut cisterns are observed on the site; most of them are filled up with materials belonging to demolished houses. A little *burj* of Musulman appearance, and constructed of stones of medium size taken from the ruins of the ancient town, show that it ceased to be inhabited after

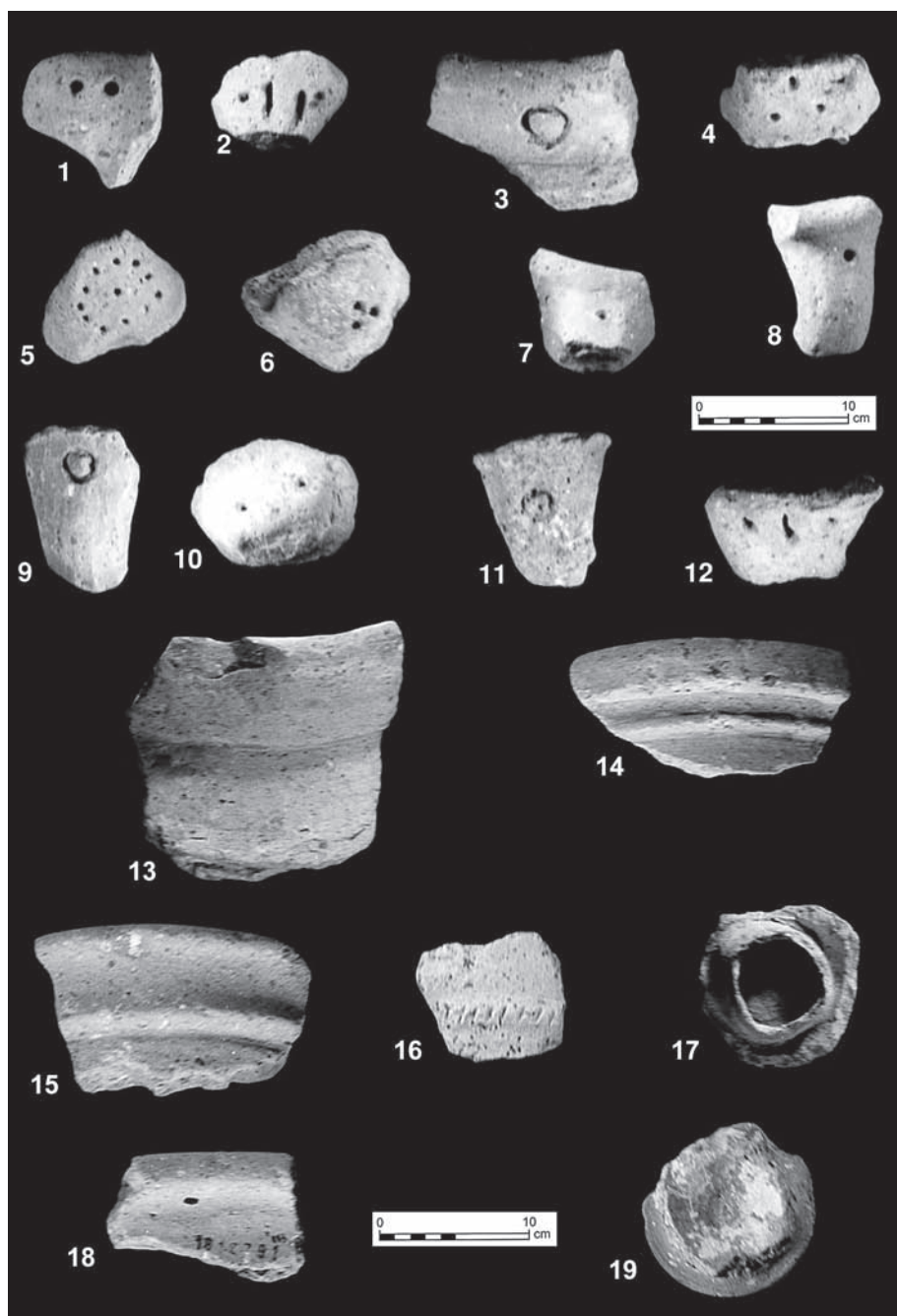
the Arab invasion”. He also mentioned the terebinth trees. Conder and Kitchenner wrote: “The ruins are those of an ordinary village, apparently modern, standing on a small hillock” and suggest a possible identification as *Aenon*, next to Salem, where John the Baptist practiced (John 3:23); yet this proposal is problematic. Identification as biblical *Thebez* (Judges 9:50 on; II Samuel 11:21) seems more plausible, and see chapter three.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 107.

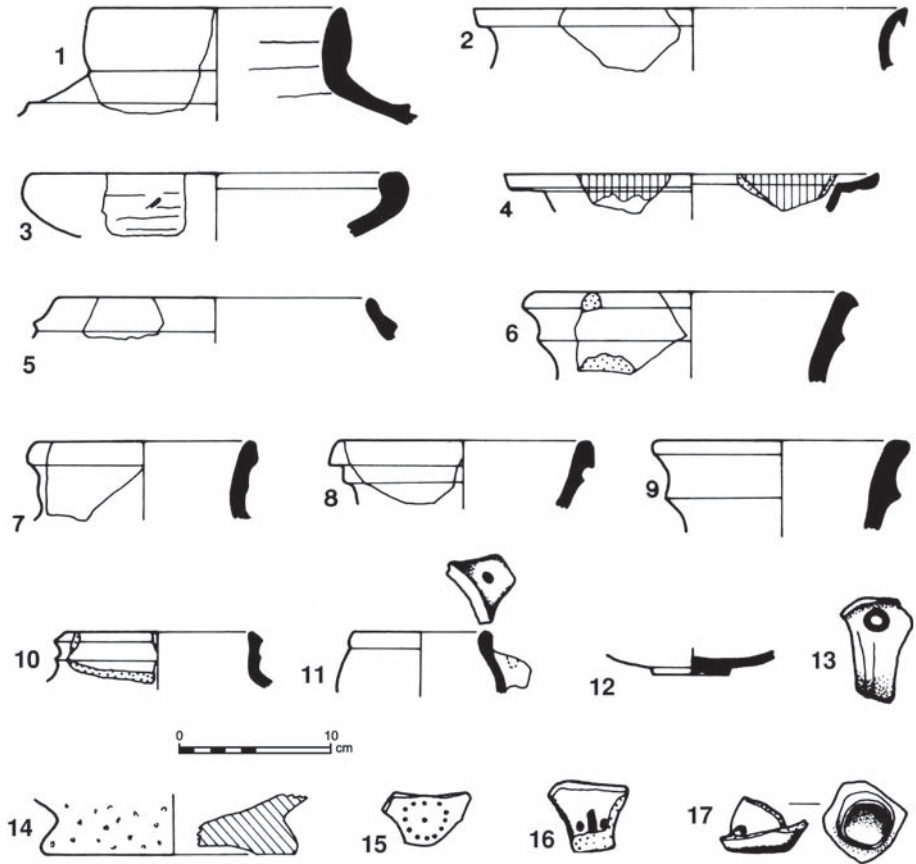
Bibliography: Guérin, 1969 (IV), 361-362; SWP II, 234.



143. A circle surrounded by large stones, of the Kh. ‘Eynun type.



144. Pottery from Kh. 'Eynun: 1-12. Handles with indented dec; 13. "Collared rim" pythos; 14-15. Ridge necked jars; 16-19. Misc.



145. Pottery from Kh. 'Eynun; no. 4 – MA; the rest – IrA I. 1. Pythos, dk; 2. CP, gray/bl, rough; 3. 'Manassite' bowl, lt br; 4. Bowl, green glaze on wh; 5. CP, dk; 6. Pythos, gray; 7-9. Jars, gray and dk; 10. Jar, br, IrA II; 11. Jug, br, indented dec; 12. Bowl base, br/gray; 13. 15-16. Handles with indented dec; 14. Bowl base, basalt; 17. 'Combined vessels', IrA II.



146. Find from Kh. 'Eynun: tip of human penis, circumcised, light brown clay.

Site 59: 18 – 18/89/1

Jelamet 'Amer

Israel grid: 1881 1897

UTM grid: 7262 5765

Elevation: 425 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin and ancient cemetery

Area: 1.2 dunams (0.3 acre)

Topography: valley edge and hilltop

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and alluvium;

quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Far'ah, no. 85), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Taiyasir – Buqe'ah junction (C19), 0.2 km distant

Visibility: 4

Nov. 20, 1980; 22 shards

* * *

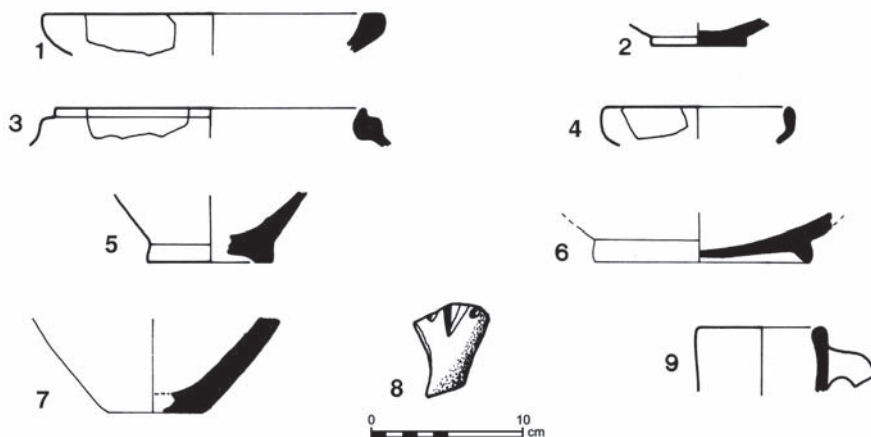
A site on a rocky hillock, about 400 m east of Kh. 'Eynun. Near it, to the north, is a dirt road leading from Taiyasir to the Buqe'ah.

Two square structures, each about 4x4 m in size, are on the hilltop. On the western slope is a hewn winepress and cup marks, about 30 cm in diameter. On the northwest

slope is a burial cave opening with a rectangular entrance and steps, including an arrangement for a burial stone. The site may have been used as a burial ground of Kh. 'Eynun.

Pottery: IrA IA – 90%; IrA II – 10%.

Previous surveys: none.



147. Pottery from Jelamet 'Amer; no. 3, 6 – IrA II; the rest – IrA I; 1, 4. 'Manassite' bowls, lt br; 2. Bowl base, yel; 3. CP, dk br; 5. Jar base, br; 6. Crater base, br; 7. Jar base, yel; 8. Handle with 'human face' dec, br; 9. Jug, br.

Site 60: 18 – 18/49/1

Khirbet el-Khrebat

Israel grid: 1849 1891

UTM grid: 7230 5759

Elevation: 235 m a.s.l., 20 m b.s.a.

Name type: historical site, but not on map

Site type: small ruin

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: valley edge, slope and ravine

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 8

Cultivation: orchards

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Far‘ah – Qabatiyeh junction (B5), 1 km distant

Visibility: 4

Dec. 9, 1982; 61 shards

* * *

A site in a small ravine on the broad slope of the ‘Asharin Range, 2 km northwest of the village of Tammun. From the site is a view of the road to Tammun and the ‘Eynun Ranges.

The four terraces of very large building stones seem to have been built from stones dismantled from the ancient settlement. The terraces are built on top of more ancient walls, about 1 m wide. A consider-



148. A view from the north, toward Kh. el-Khrebat. The site is at the bottom of the olive grove. In the background are the ‘Asharin Ranges between Tammun and Tel el-Far‘ah. 1983.

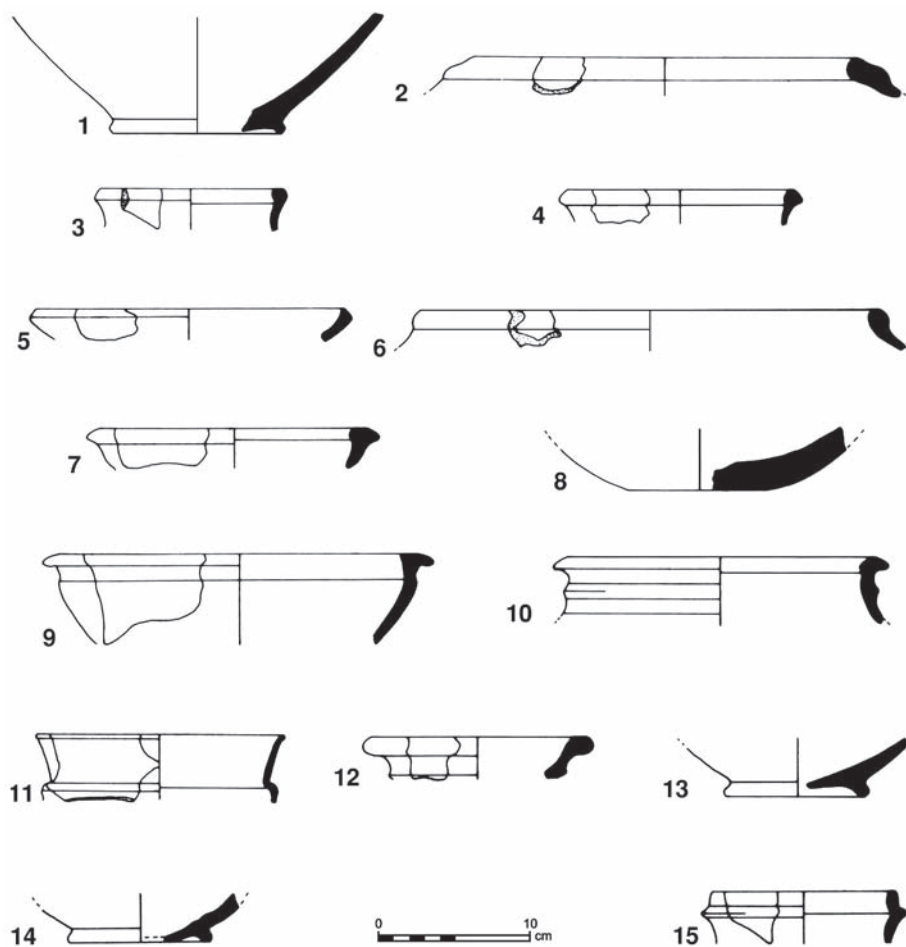
able shard scatter is around these terraces, and a rock surface with hewn cistern is located north of it. Beside it was a grinding stone.

This is one of a series of Middle Bronze Age sites in the eastern val-

leys of Manasseh. Most of them were abandoned at the end of that period.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



149. Pottery from Kh. el-Khrebat, all from MBA IIB: 1. Crater, yel; 2. CP, dk br; 3-4. Jars, gray; 5. Bowl, pk; 6. CP, dk gray; 7, 10. Jars, pinkish; 8-9. Craters, br; 11. Carinated bowl, yel; 12-15. Bowls and jugs, lt.

Site 61: 18 – 18/48/1

Khallet Abu-Toq

Israel grid: 1843 1884

UTM grid: 7224 5753

Elevation: 280 m a.s.l., 35 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: large ruin

Area: 10.8 dunams (2.7 acres)

Topography: valley edge, slope and ravine

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 8

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 3

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Far‘ah, no. 85), 2.5 km distant

Nearest road: Far‘ah – Qabatiyeh junction (B5), 1 km distant

Visibility: 3

Dec. 9, 1982; 70 shards

* * *

A site in a wide ravine at the western edge of the ‘Asharin Range, about 2 km west-northwest of the village of Tammun. Jebel Abu Loz rises to the west and above the site. A good path from Tammun to Tel el-Far‘ah

passes through the site.

Many building remains, on the slope and in the ravine, are found here. They include complete walls of large, unhewn stones. Plenty of building stones have been cleared



150. Khallet Abu-Toq, looking east. The site's houses once covered the ravine in the foreground. A central structure was found in the olive orchard at right, next to the cypress tree. In the distant background the ‘Asharin Ranges are visible. Winter 1982.

and moved to the terraces in the wadi bed. In consequence, most plans are unclear, yet some houses with courtyards can be identified. In an orchard close to the path, on the western part of the site, there is a large structure (10x20 m), about 2 m high with a modern structure on top of a modern one. Cleared

stones are piled on top of it and a wealth of shards is scattered, over the site.

There was once a large, agricultural village here, belonging to the 'settlement wave' of the Middle Bronze Age in the eastern valleys.

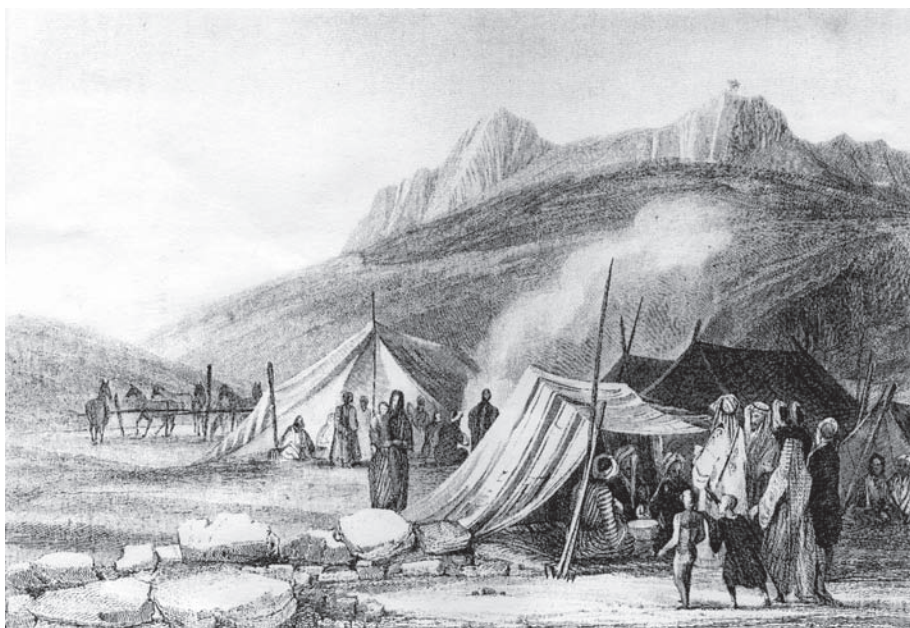
Pottery: MBA IIB – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.

CHAPTER SEVEN

WADI MALIH

LANDSCAPE UNIT 15



A Bedouin encampment, etching by A. Taylor, 1830

Site 62: 19 – 19/28/1

Khallet el-Kebarah

Israel grid: 1928 1981	soil; quality: 4
UTM grid: 7308 5851	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 210 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: nearest place	Nearest water source: spring ('Ain Bardaleh, no. 91), 2.5 km distant
Site type: shard scatter and walls	Nearest road: Salhab – Beth Shean Junction (B7), 0.8 km distant
Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)	Visibility: 4
Topography: ridge	April 15, 1988; 39 shards
Rock type: Judah formation	
Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest	

* * *

A small site on a shoulder, descending into the southern part of Beth Shean Valley.

A medium sized shard scatter and a few remnants of walls were

detected. A dirt road from Wadi Khashneh to Kh. Jabaris passes next to the site.

Pottery: MBA I – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 63: 19 – 19/38/1

Wadi Salman

Israel grid: 1933 1981	Cultivation: none
UTM grid: 7312 5851	Cisterns: 1
Elevation: 160 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.	Nearest water source: spring ('Ain Kardaleh, no. 115), 2 km distant
Name type: nearest place	Nearest road: Salhab – Beth Shean Junction (B7), 0.8 km distant
Site type: fortress	Visibility: 7
Area: 0.5 dunam (0.125 acre)	Jan. 29, 1988; 19 shards
Topography: hilltop	
Rock type: Judah formation	
Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 1	

* * *

A fortress on a high hilltop in the hilly area between Bardaleh and Kh. Jabaris, about 2.5 km west-southwest of Bardaleh.

The fortress consists of two fortified structures, one inside the other.

The outer of the two is rectangular and well built, measuring 13.5x13.5 m. The surrounding wall is wide (1.4 m) and built of large, hewn stones. The entrance, 1 m wide, is on the southeastern side. The inner

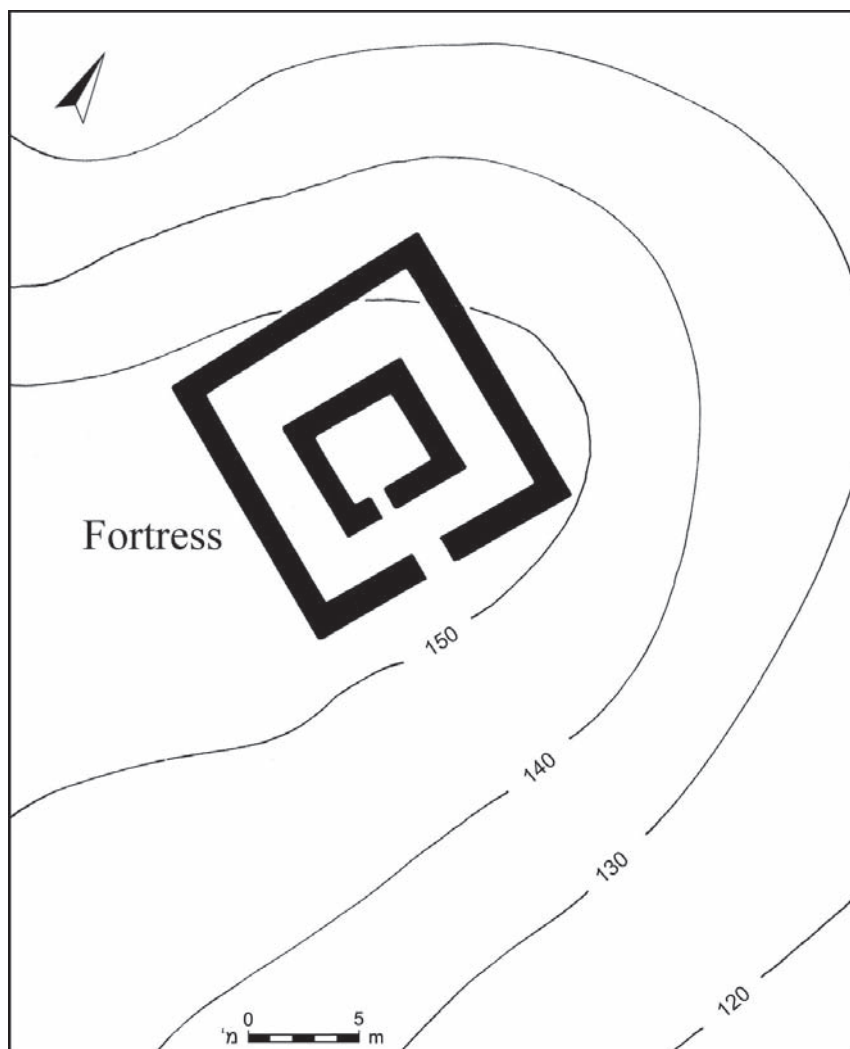
structure is similar by shape, 6x6 m in size and built of especially large, hewn stones. The space between the inner and outer structures is 4 m, and the inner structure stands 1 m higher than the outer ones. Its walls, like the outer ones, are 1.4 m wide; a 2 m wide entrance was

found on its southeastern side.

The place was apparently used as an observation fort on the path leading through Wadi Khashneh and the southern Beth Shean Valley.

Pottery: LR – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



151. The plan of the fortress at Wadi Salman, including the double fortified structure. Winter 1988.



152. The Roman fortress at Wadi Salman, seen from the west. It is situated on a high peak overlooking the southern Beth Shean Valley.



Site 64: 19 – 19/68/1

Kardaleh (Upper)

Israel grid: 1961 1985

UTM grid: 7340 5855

Elevation: 60 m b.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.125 acre)

Topography: ridge

Rock type: Tiberias formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean

brown forest soil; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain Kardaleh, no. 115), 0.2 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Hammeh (B10), 1 km distant

Visibility: 6

Jan. 29, 1988; 41 shards

* * *

A small site on a wide ridge descending into the southern Beth Shean Valley, between Bardaleh and Tel el-Hammeh.

A concentration of shards and

one wall of field stones were found there.

Pottery: MBA I - 20%; Byz – 50%; Ott – 30%.

Previous surveys: none.



153. A traditional structure in Kardaleh (Upper). Note the construction of the openings and the mud plastering. The structure was built at the end of 19th century or the beginning of the 20th. Winter 1988.



154. Pottery from Kardaleh (Upper): 1, 6. Folded ledge handles, yel, MBA I; 2-4. Jar rims, lt br, Byz; 5. Jug handle, dk, Ott.

Site 65: 19 – 19/07/1

Wadi Khashneh

Israel grid: 1909 1975

UTM grid: 7288 5843

Elevation: 175 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 3 dunams (0.75 acre)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain Bar-daleh, no. 91), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Salhab – Beth Shean junction (B7), passes by site

Visibility: 1

April 15, 1988; 47 shards

* * *

A well preserved farm next to Wadi Khashneh, at the bottom of a slope descending into the wadi.

There is a structure here, built of large, hewn stones with mortar,

whose dimensions are 7x12 m. The well preserved first floor contains two rooms and the beginning of the second floor level. Adjacent to the structure is a large, open courtyard



155. A milestone next to the Roman road of Wadi Khashneh. The road, leading from Neapolis to Scythopolis, was published by Tomsen (1917, milestones no. 248-255) at the beginning of the 20th century. Its remains have been well preserved in various sections. 1985.

with a cistern. Next to the farm are large agricultural areas, terraces and additional buildings.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: Porath 1968, no. 26.



Site 66: 19 – 19/67/1

Wadi el-Hammeh

Israel grid: 1968 1975

UTM grid: 7348 5846

Elevation: 45 m b.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure and shard scatter

Area: 1.7 dunams (0.4 acre)

Topography: slope

Rock type: Tiberias formation

Soil type: mountainous rendzina;

quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Hammeh, no. 116), 0.2 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Hammeh (B10), 0.5 km distant

Visibility: 4

May 16, 1986; 36 shards and 9 flint find

A site dispersed over a moderate slope descending eastward to the valley of Tel el-Hammeh, about 2 km northwest of the Israeli settlement of Meholah.

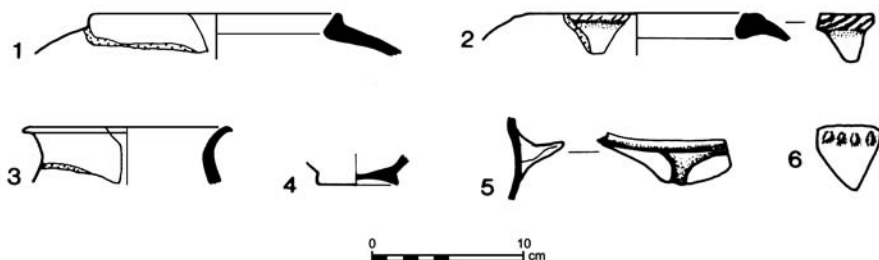
Several structures built of small field stones, whose plans are unclear, are strewn over the slope. East of the site is a structure measur-

ing 4x6 m, built of large, unhewn stones. Over the area of the site there is a medium sized shard scatter.

Pottery: MBA I – 80%; MBA IIB – 20%.

Flint find: MBA I, with one from the Chal; see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



156. Shards from Wadi el-Hammeh: nos. 1-3, 5 – MBA I; the rest – MBA II: 1-2. HM jars with cut rim and rope dec, yel; 3. Jar, gray; 4. Bowl base, lt; 5. Folded ledge handle, yel; 6. Plastic dec.

Site 67: 19 – 19/77/2

Khirbet el-Hammeh

Israel grid: 1972 1975

UTM grid: 7352 5846

Elevation: 120 m b.s.l., 50 m b.s.a.

Name type: historical site, but not on map

Site type: large site

Area: 12 dunams (3 acres)

Topography: valley

Rock type: alluvium covering

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 7

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 8

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Hammeh, no. 116), passes by site

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Hammeh (B10), passes by site

Visibility: 2

May 16, 1986; 89 shards

* * *

A large ruin in an internal valley extending west, south and north of the ancient Tell of el-Hammeh. The spring of 'Ain el-Hammeh flows by the side of the ruin.

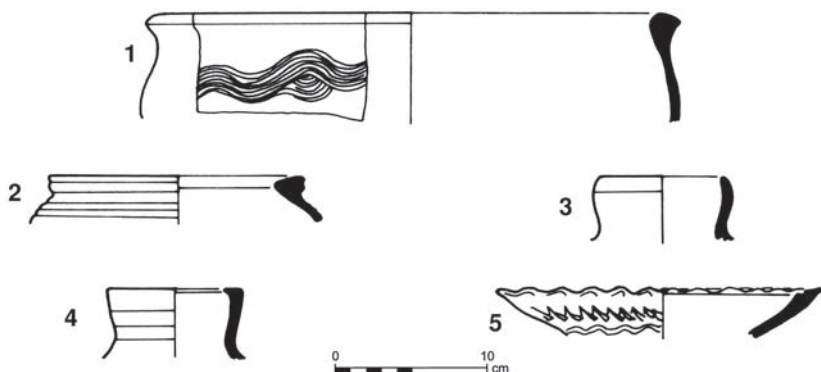
A good many building remains, including walls, floors and hewn building stones, are scattered through the valley. The structures, whose plans have been made indistinct by cultivation, extend to the edges of the hills. Large shard and

glass scatters were found all over the area.

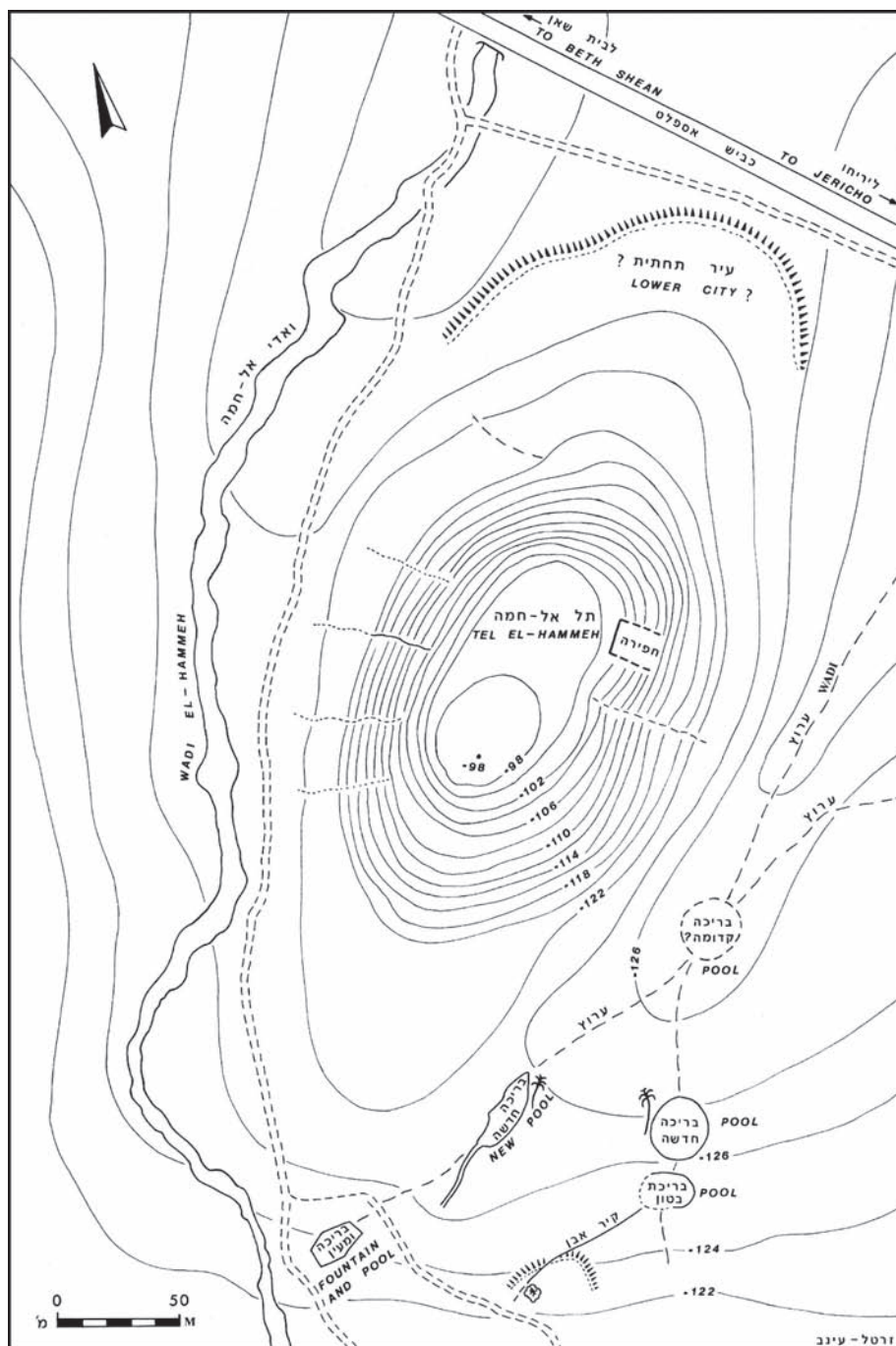
This town, which seems to have replaced the high Tel el-Hammeh, was founded in the Byzantine Period, when the entire area was irrigated by spring water. The site is mentioned neither in SWP nor by Guérin.

Pottery: Byz – 30%; EM – 40%; MA – 30%.

Previous surveys: none.



157. Shards from the 'late' ruin near Tel el-Hammeh, all EM: 1. Crater, dk gray; 2. Bowl, dk; 3-4. Jars, br; 5. Bowl, dk.



158. Plan of the Tel and Kh. el-Hammeh. The Khirbeh is located south and east of the Tel, near the springs, 2001.



159. Kh. el-Hammeh and Tel el-Hammeh in the lower edges of the Beth Shean Valley, looking east. The later ruin is in the foreground, with remains over across the valley, adjacent to the springs. Spring 1986.



Site 68: 18 – 19/96/1

Qasr esh-Shekh Ghazal

Israel grid: 1892 1960

UTM grid: 7270 5828

Elevation: 320 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: roadside fortress (?)

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: edge of mountainous ravine

Rock type: Mount Scopus formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Meiyyiteh, no. 90), 7 km distant

Nearest road: Salhab – Beth Shean junction (B7), 1 km distant

Visibility: 3

May 21, 1993; 49 shards

A fortified structure and a courtyard in a broad ravine in Wadi Khashneh. The wadi flows through the mountainous block north of Wadi Malih, about 2.5 km northeast of Taiyasir.

The site is located east of the ravine, near the road from Wadi Khashneh to Wadi Malih. The entire complex is built upon terraces on the slope. The central building, 8x10 m in size, is built of large, hewn and collapsed stones, now covering the internal plan. North

of the building and attached to it is a small courtyard, 10x15 m in size, surrounded by a stone wall and containing a cistern.

This may have been a roadside fortress on the Wadi Khashneh roads, as suggested by Neef, and see chapter three.

Pottery: IrA II – 20%; LR – 50%; Byz – 30%.

Previous surveys: none.

Bibliography: Avi Yonah 1976, 124; Neef 1982.



160. The roadside fortress (?) at Qasr esh-Sheikh Ghazal, looking southwest. The person stands on the structure's remains; behind them is Wadi Khashneh with the Roman road to Scythopolis. The high range in the background is Ras Jadir. 1993.

Site 69: 19 – 19/26/1

Khirbet Jabaris (SWP map: Kh. Jebrish)

Israel grid: 1924 1962

UTM grid: 7301 5834

Elevation: 300 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: large ruin

Area: 11.8 dunams (3 acres)

Topography: saddle on plateau

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa and brown basalt soils; quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 35

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain el-Meiyiteh, no. 86), 4.5 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 3.5 km distant

Visibility: 2

Jan. 9, 1983; May 23, 1986; Jul. 9, 1993; 149 shards.

* * *

A large settlement on a saddle, in the high area between Wadi Malih and Wadi Khashneh, about 4 km northwest of the hot springs at Hamam el-Malih. Several families

from Tubas (the el-Fauqa family and others) live in the place, a center for sheep husbandry.

The saddle, on which the houses of the settlement were built, de-



161. Aerial photo of Kh. Jabaris, looking east. Ruins of two towers are seen in the upper part, and beside them is a built road that crosses the site lengthwise. At right is the new dirt path from Wadi Malih and at bottom left are the plowed fields of the ravine.

scends to the southwest from the summit of E.P. 334, near a small, internal valley. About 50 well preserved structures were recorded here, built of large, hewn stones. Most of the structures, with doorposts, arches and architraves, are of the courtyard house type. In the center of the settlement is a plastered pool and another one, with well preserved supporting arches, is located north of the site. To its northeast three large structures were also found, possibly *mausolea* (our opinion) but identified as watch-towers by the SWP. Burial caves are scattered over the area.

In the town's center there is a basalt type structure (7.5X6.5 m, inner dimensions), directed north

– southwest, with an opening in the southwestern wall and two stone benches next to the southern wall. The ashlar built entrance is partly decorated. The building seems to be a Byzantine Period monastery from the 5th-6th Centuries C.E. While exploring the place, the SWP mentioned a mosaic floor there; this was revisited by Makhouly in 1932. He unearthed two pieces of the colorful mosaic floor, measuring 1X1.5 m and depicting a grapevine emerging from a jug. The pattern consists of a square with inner circles in white, yellow and red. During a tour of the area in 1973, with the participation of Ilan, Ovadia and Arav, a mosaic inscription was found in front of the entrance.



162. Crushing basin of the “grinding stone” type, close to the site. Winter 1993.

It contained four lines in ancient Greek, deciphered by Drs. A. Ova-diah and V. Tzafirir. The text speaks of the paving of the building by a certain 'Omnius the priest' (?), the head of the monastery (?), in the in-diction ... (Byzantine calendar)". It

is dated to the Sixth Century C.E.

Throughout the settlement ar-chitectural elements, pillars, wine-presses, cisterns and burial niches were discovered.

Pottery: Byz – 80%; EM – 20%.

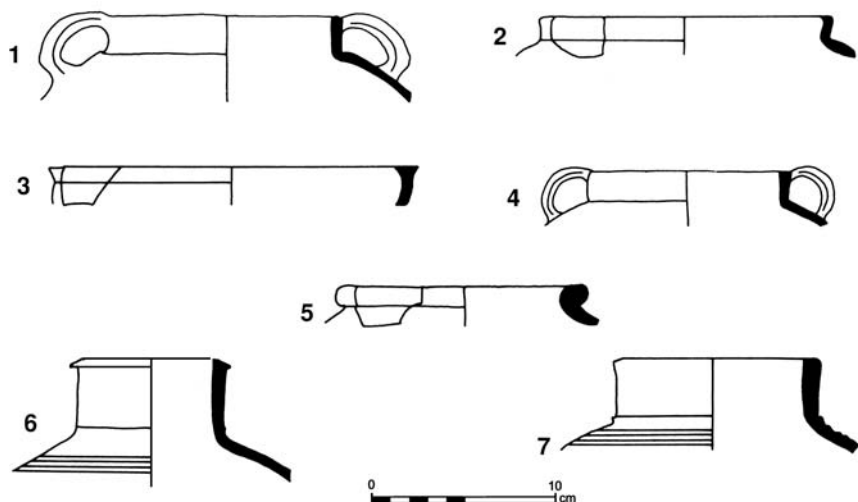


163. Plan of the town from the Byzantine Period at Kh. Jabaris. The lower quarter of the site was not measured with an alidade, but was taken from the aerial photo.

During a partial survey in 1972 Ilan, following Avi Yonah, suggested identifying this as one of the two *Bezeq's* of the Onomasticon; see chapter three.

Bibliography: SWP II, 238; *Archaeological News* 47 (1973), 11-12; Ilan 1973, 349-351; 1976.

Previous surveys: none.



164. Pottery from Kh. Jabaris, all Byz: 1. CP, dk br; 2. Bowl, dk br; 3. Bowl, gray; 4. CP, dk gray; 5. Krater, br; 6-7. Jars, dk gray.



Site 70: 19 – 19/35/1

er-Raqqeh

Israel grid: 1933 1958

UTM grid: 7312 5825

Elevation: 300 m a.s.l., 50 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: built courtyard

Area: 3 dunams (0.75 acre)

Topography: slope and valley edge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Meiyiteh, no. 86), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 3 km distant

Visibility: 1

July 2, 1993; 78 shards

A large courtyard on a low slope above Wadi Jabaris, 1 km east-southeast of Kh. Jabaris.

The courtyard, measuring about 35x45 m, is trapezoid in shape. The surrounding wall, which varies

in width between 1-2 m, is composed of two rows of large, hewn stones, with a filling in between. The assumed entrance is in the eastern wall. A wall enters into the courtyard, bends and ends with two hewn, plastered cisterns. Inside there are also two caves. Another cistern is on the slope, some 30 m northwest of the courtyard.

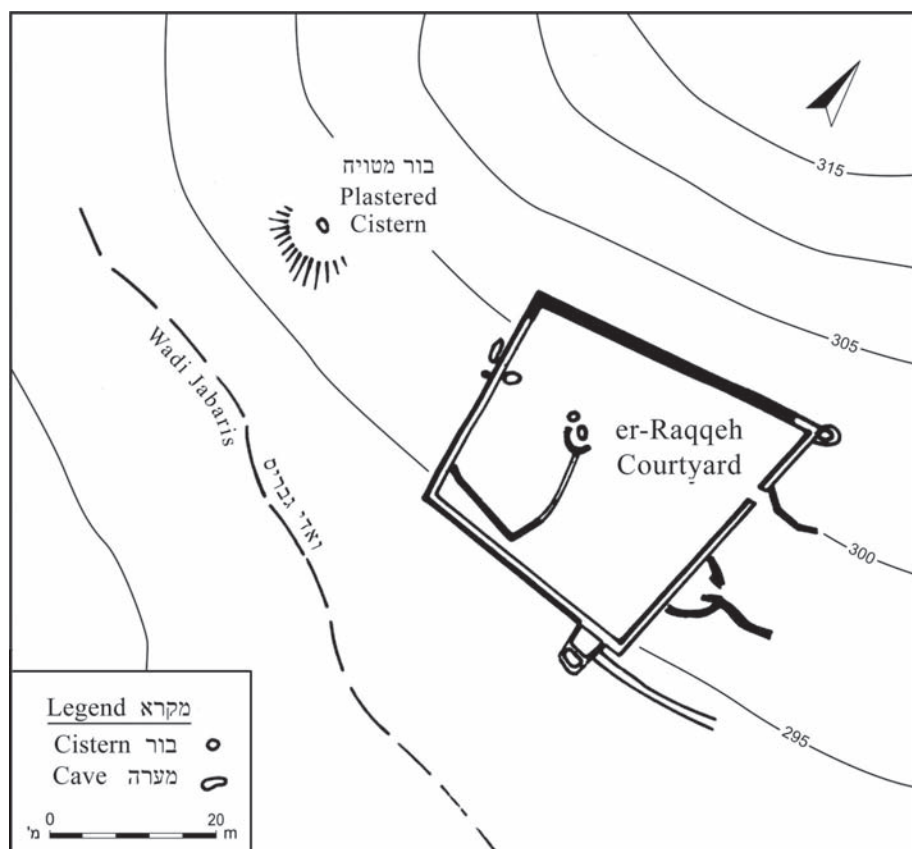
The original structure dates to the Late Roman Period. At some later stage a secondary use was made of the stones, when three

semi-circular structures were added to the original walls and an animal pen (the bent wall inside) was built in the southern corner.

In a nearby wadi to the west, stone wall casings and remains of a possible dam were found. Beyond the wadi and close to the modern road there are remains of a Roman road, apparently leading from Hamam el-Malih to Kh. Jabaris.

Pottery: LR – 55%; Byz – 28%, MA (Mameluk) – 17%.

Previous surveys: none.



165. The plan of the courtyard/pen at er-Raqqeh. Spring 1993.



166. The courtyard/pen from the Late Roman Period and the surrounding structures of er-Raqqeh, looking north. Kh. Jabaris is on the saddle above, with the large terebinth trees nearby.



Site 71: 19 – 19/46/1

Umm Khubezah

Israel grid: 1948 1965

UTM grid: 7328 5838

Elevation: 120 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.125 acre)

Topography: broad ridge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean

brown forest soil; quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain Bardaleh, no. 91), 2 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Hammeh (B10), 2.5 km distant

Visibility: 6

Jan. 8, 1988; 8 shards

A rectangular structure on a flat hilltop in the center of a ridge, surrounded by deep ravines, some 2.5 km south-southwest of Bardaleh.

The structure, 5x10 m in size, built of large, unhewn stones, with clear internal division into rooms. Three m to the east there is a sup-

porting wall, and two hewn cisterns are located 15 m in the same direction. Nearby are many agricultural remains (terraces, towers, etc.).

The dating is uncertain, due to

only two identifiable shards having been found.

Pottery: MBA IIB (?).

Flint find: Two undefined items.

Previous surveys: none.



167. The remains of the solitary structure from Middle Bronze Age IIB (?) at Umm Khubezah. In the background are the hills between Hamam el-Malih and the Beth Shean Valley. Winter 1988.

Site 72: 19 – 19/45/1

‘Iraq ej-Jaddab

Israel grid: 1946 1955

UTM grid: 7326 5824

Elevation: 84 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 1.5 dunams (0.4 acre)

Topography: broad ridge

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean

brown forest soil; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain Hammeh, no. 116), 4 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 2.5 km distant

Visibility: 4

May 23, 1986; 39 shards.

* * *

A well preserved farm on a moderate slope, in the hilly area north of Wadi Malih, about 2 km east of Kh. Jabaris.

In the upper, northern part of the farm is a building of large field

stones, 6x11 m in size. It is divided into three rooms, with an entrance from the west and preserved doorposts. Of the rooms, the western two are small and equal to each other, while the eastern one is larger. South of the structure is an ir-



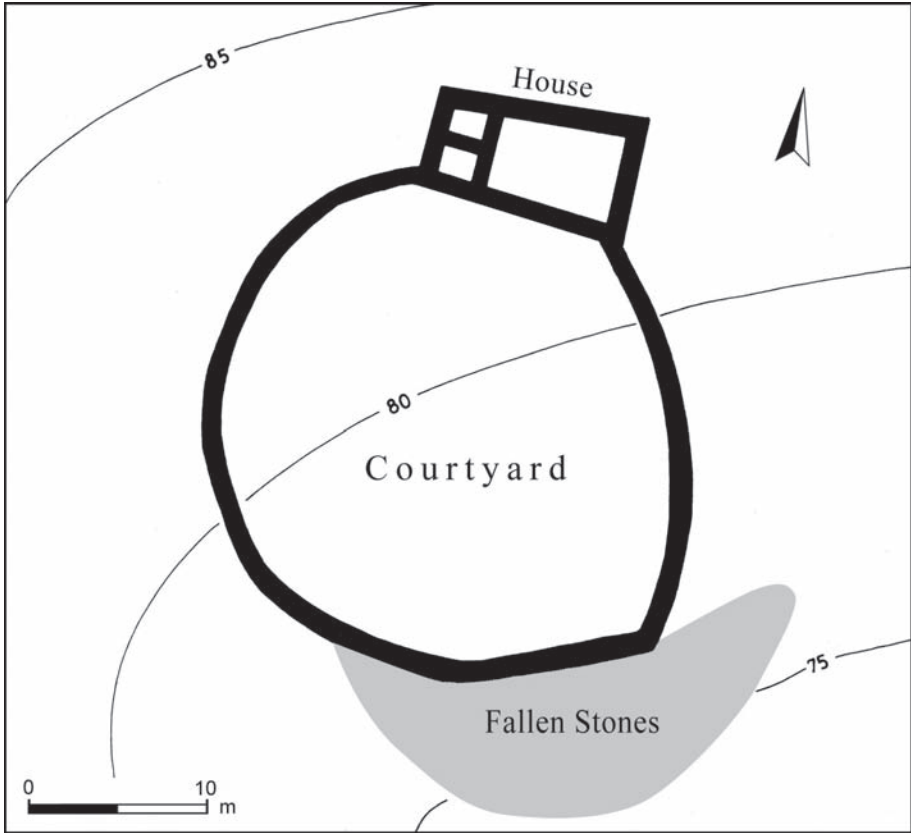
168. A view of the courtyard of the Byzantine Period farm at ‘Iraq ej-Jaddab, looking south from the central structure. 1986.

regular shaped, attached courtyard, 26x26 m in size, with rounded corners, surrounded by a stone wall 60 cm wide. East of the farm are stone

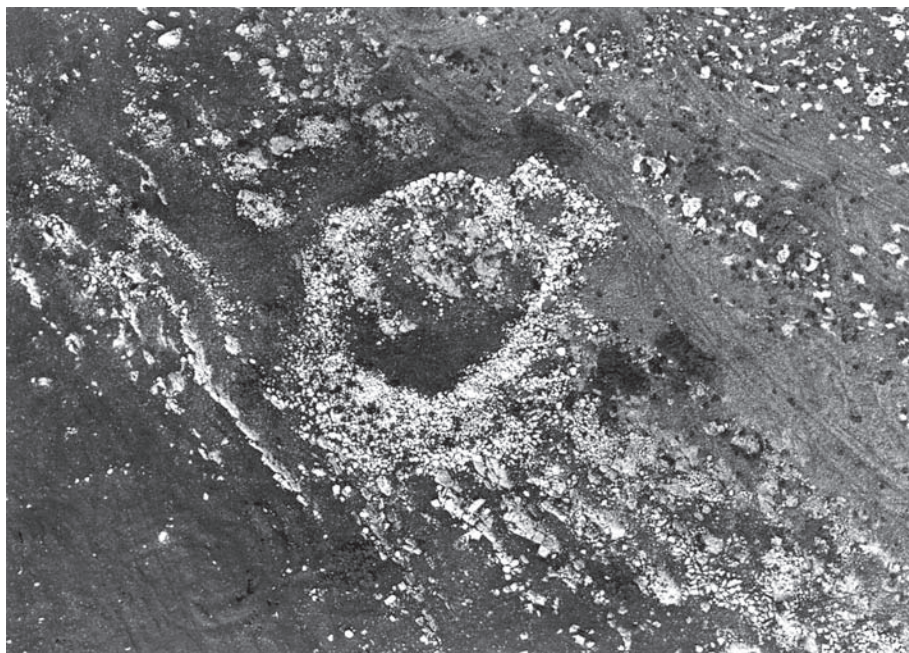
built, agricultural terraces.

Pottery: Byz – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



169. Plan of the Byzantine Period farm of 'Iraq ej-Jaddab. In the hilly region between Kh. Jabaris and the Beth Shean Valley are several small farms of this type, while the large sites are located in Wadi Malih or in the Beth Shean Valley. Winter 1994.



170. Aerial photo of the Byzantine Period farm of 'Iraq ej-Jaddab, looking north.
Winter 1994.



Site 73: 19 – 19/75/3

Khirbet Wadi esh-Shaqq

Israel grid: 1972 1954

UTM grid: 7352 5823

Elevation: 105 m b.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 3 dunams (0.75 acre)

Topography: ridge bottom and valley edge

Rock type: Tiberias formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean

brown forest soil; quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Khimyar, no. 117), 0.5 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 1

Jan. 22, 1988; 60 shards; Oct. 2006

An enclosure on the northern bank of Wadi esh-Shaqq, in the northwestern part of esh-Shaqq Valley, 2 km southwest of Meholah.

Deep wadis isolate the place from its environs.

The enclosure is square-shaped but slightly irregular, about 50x50

m in size. The surrounding wall is of large stones. Inside it is a separate area enclosed by an internal stone wall. In the southeastern corner of the court is a small structure, where parts of a complete Roman cooking pot were unearthed under one of the stones. In the vicinity to the

northeast is another structure, and a stone dam was found in the wadi to the east.

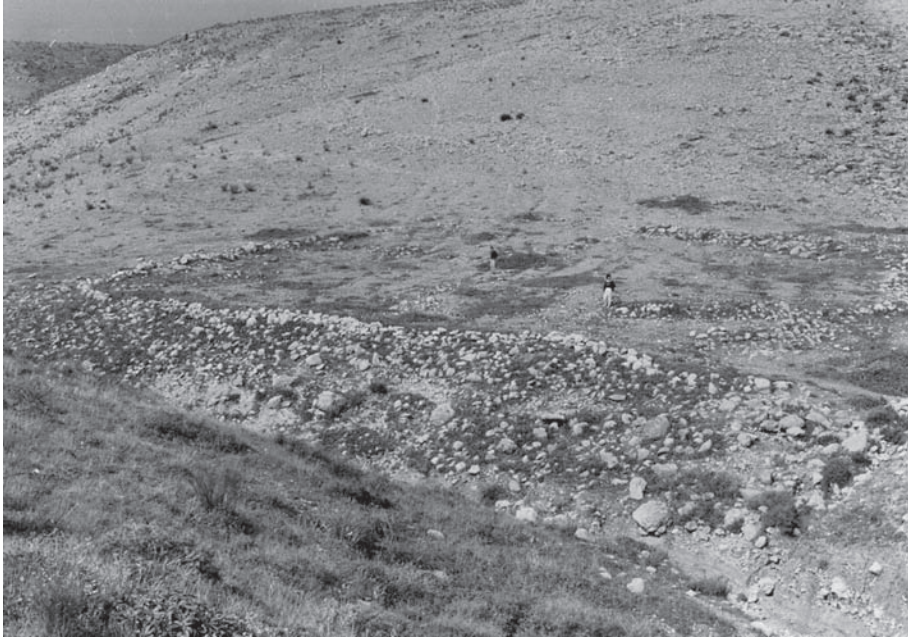
Pottery: MBA IIB – 10%; LR – 40%; EM – 20%; Ott – 30%.

Special find: Clay pipe, Ott.

Previous surveys: none.



171. Plan of Kh. Wadi esh-Shaqq. The enclosure has at least two stages, 2006.



172. View to the northwest of the enclosure of Kh. Wadi esh-Shaqq, in the northern extremity of esh-Shaqq Valley. The enclosure, used over many periods, is situated above a wadi and below the ridges of Jebel el-Khimyar. Winter 1988.



Site 74: 19 – 19/75/1

Khallet Khimyar

Israel grid: 1976 1955

UTM grid: 7355 5824

Elevation: 130 m b.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: a small site; farm (?)

Area: 3 dunams (0.75 acre)

Topography: valley edge

Rock type: Tiberias formation

Soil type: Colluvial – Alluvial; quality:

5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Khimyar, no. 117), next to site

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 0.75 km distant

Visibility: 2

Apr. 11, 1986; 70 shards

* * *

A small site, perhaps a farm, on the edge of esh-Shaqq Valley, some 2 km southwest of Meholah.

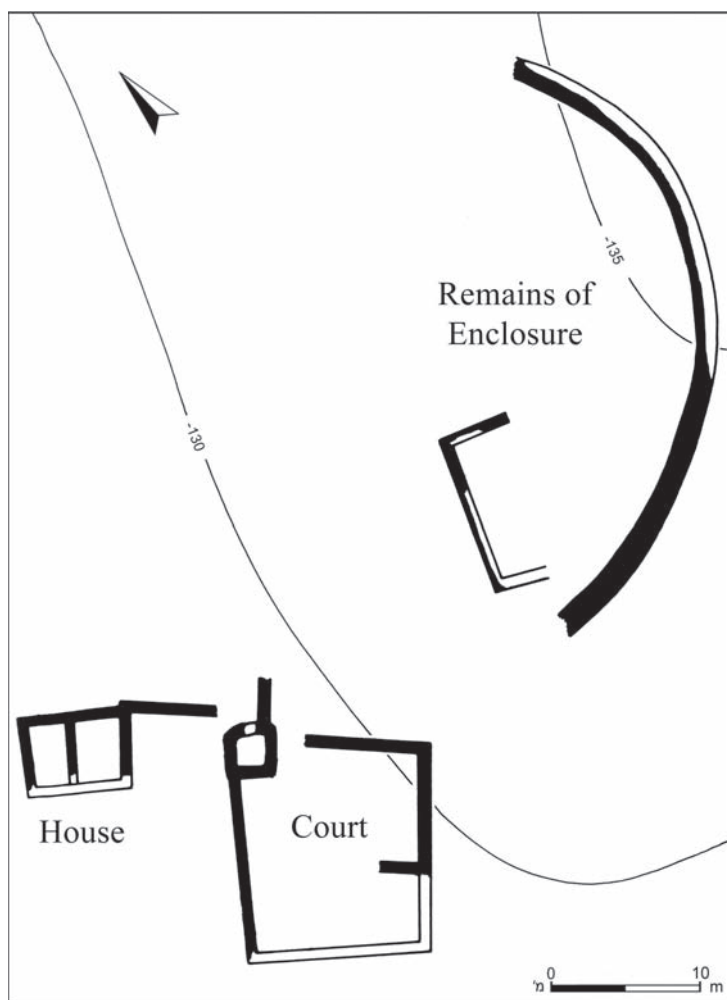
In the center of the site the remains of a central complex, which consists of two parts, are found. In

its upper part there is a structure with two or three square rooms 3X3 m in size. East of this, and below it on the slope, is a large room or an internal courtyard 12X16 m in size. These seem to have been originally parts of the same complex. They are surrounded by a wall of large stones. Another wall, about 1 m wide, de-

scends from the structure into the wadi. Northeast of the structure is a rounded wall, presumably part of an ancient enclosure, 36 m in diameter. Remains of another square structure are within it.

Pottery: IrA II – 10%; Per – 30%; Hel – 30%; ER – 30%.

Previous surveys: none.



173. Plan of the farm (?) at Khallet Khimyar in the northern extremity of esh-Shaqq Valley. Northeast of the site's structures (upper right) are a rounded wall and the remains of additional structures, apparently belonging to the early stages of the site.

Site 75: 19 – 19/75/2

Jebel Khimyar

Israel grid: 1978 1953

UTM grid: 7357 5825

Elevation: 90 m b.s.l., 70 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site and fortress (?)

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: high summit

Rock type: Tiberias formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean

brown forest soil; quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Khimyar, no. 117), 0.4 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 0.6 km distant

Visibility: 7

Apr. 8, 1988; 49 shards

* * *

A fortified site on the summit of a mountainous block overlooking esh-Shaqq Valley, the delta of Wadi Malih and the southern Beth Shean Valley. It is located 2 km southwest of Meholah.

Remains of a large courtyard, 45x30 m in size, enclose the high summit. It consists of remnants of a wall built of large stones. Various walls, possibly rooms, join its northern side. In the southwest corner of this wall are remains of a

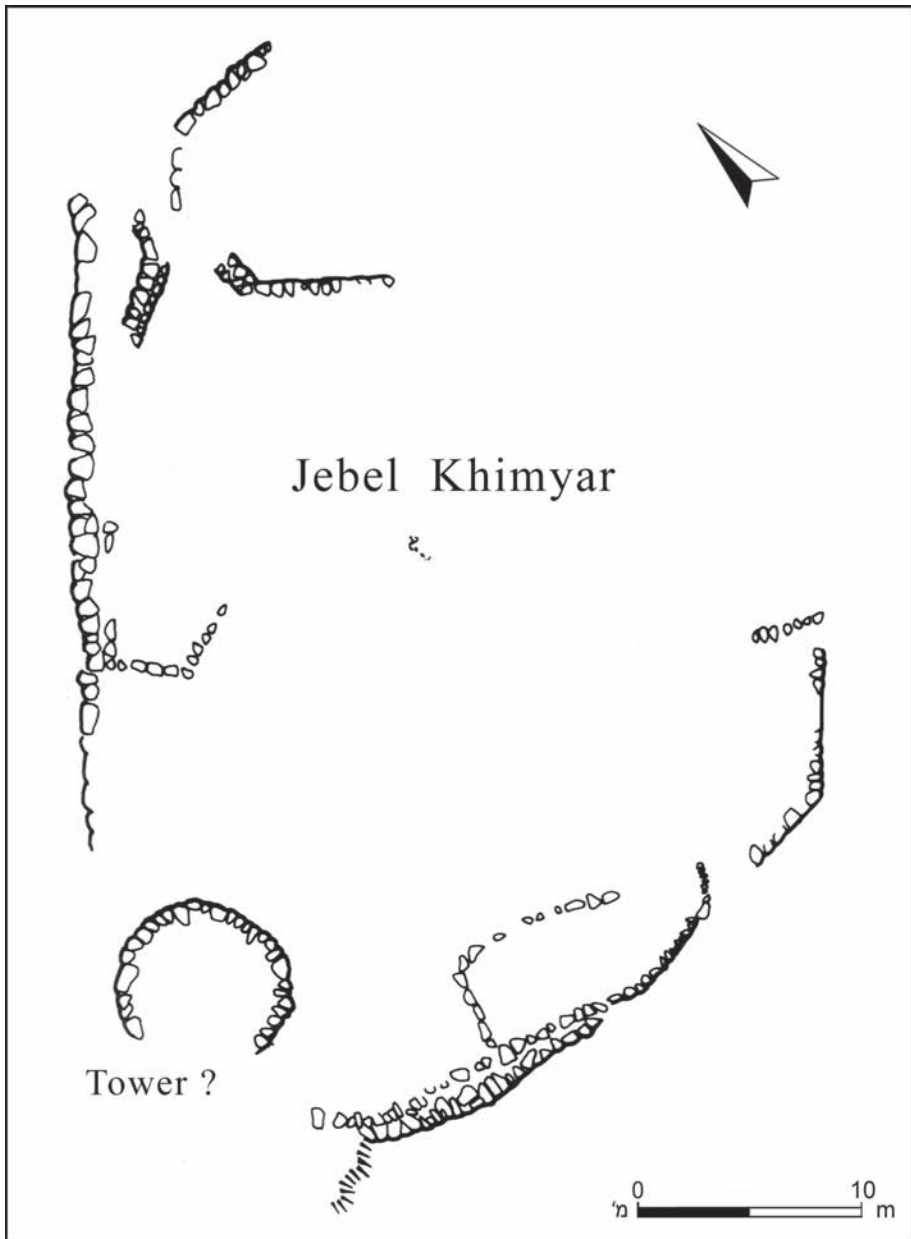


174. The entrance to esh-Shaqq Valley, looking northwest, from the southern plains of Beth Shean Valley. In the center is Jebel Khimyar, with the fortress on its high summit. To the left esh-Shaqq Valley is visible and to its right is Wadi Khimyar. Spring 1988.

round structure, perhaps a corner tower, with shards from the Late Roman Period.

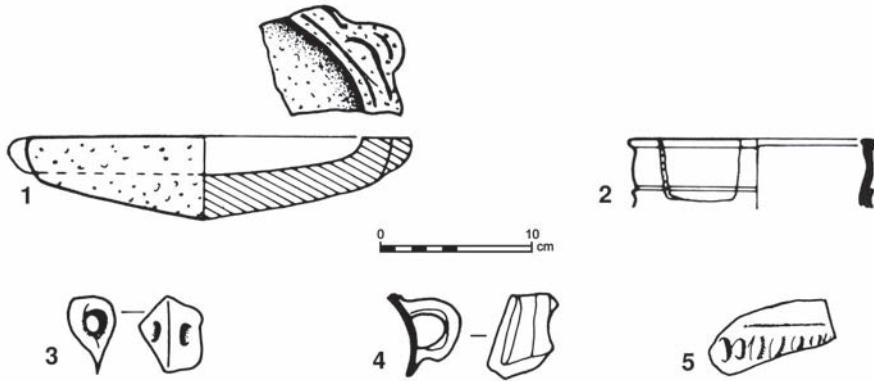
The place appears to be a fortified outlook fortress.

Pottery: MBA I – 10%; MBA IIB



175. Plan of the site at Jebel Khimyar. The remains include a wall of large stones and a round tower. The location and fortification define the site as a possible fortress.

– 40%; LR – 20%; Byz – 20%; MA – 10%. *Previous surveys:* none.



176. Pottery and other finds from the fortress at Jebel Khimyar: 1. Basalt bowl with carved handle; 2. Jar, lt br, LR; 3. Loop-handle, yel, MBA I; 4. Jar handle, br, Byz; 5. Rope dec, yel, MBA II.



Site 76: 19 – 19/74/2

Khirbet Wadi edh-Dhb'ah

Israel grid: 1977 1949

UTM grid: 7354 5820

Elevation: 120 m b.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site

Area: 4.5 dunams (1.25 acres)

Topography: slope and valley edge

Rock type: Tiberias formation

Soil type: Colluvial – Alluvial; quality:

4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain esh-Shaqq, no. 89), 0.3 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 1 km distant

Visibility: 2

May 11, 1986; 108 shards

A small site on the western fringes of esh-Shaqq Valley, between the Wadis esh-Shaqq and edh-Dhb'ah, about 2.5 km southwest of Meholah.

A wide anti tank trench crosses the site. In the cross section created

by the trench, a dark layer and remains of floors and walls were discovered. On the slope and above the trench are a few walls and a large shard scatter. About 0.1 km south of the place, flint tools from the Middle Paleolithic (Musterian-

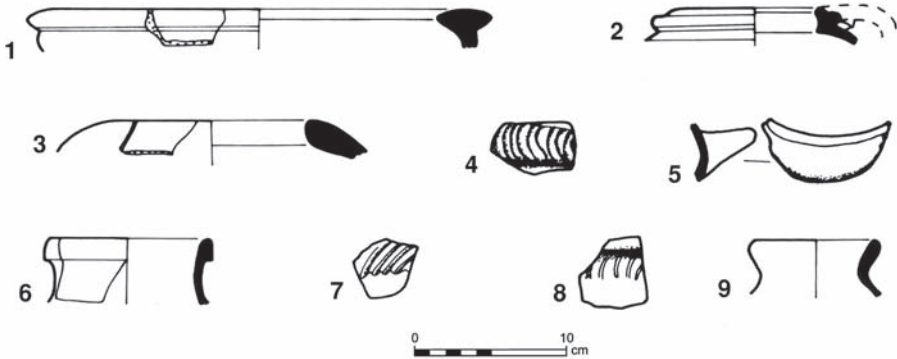
Levallois) Period were collected. In the anti tank trench the top of a jar from the Persian Period was found *in situ*.

Pottery: Chal – 5%; EBA I – 15%;

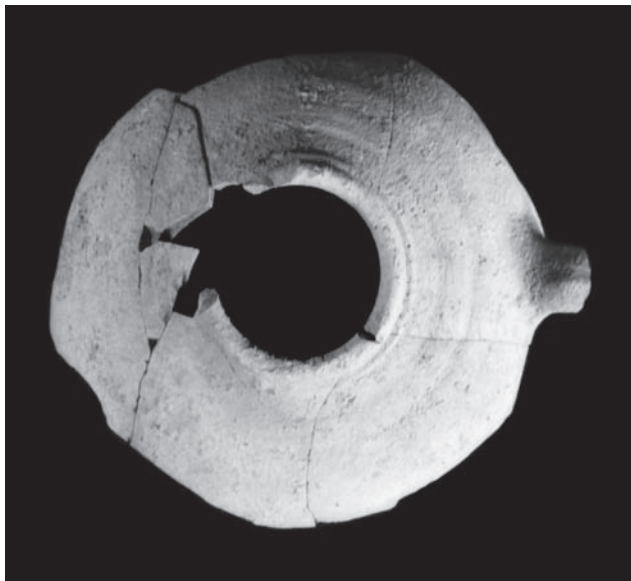
IrA III – 15%; Per – 25%; Hel – 25%; ER – 10%; LR – 5%.

Flint find: Ten items from Chal or EBA.

Previous surveys: none.



177. Pottery from Kh. Wadi edh-Dhb'ah: 1. Crater, br, IrA II-III; 2. Jar, br, IrA III; 3. HM jar, br, EBA; 4. Rope dec, lt, Chal; 5. Ledge handle, lt br, 'Far'ah family'; 6. Jar, yel, Per; 7-8. Rope dec, 'Far'ah family'; 9. Jar, br, LR.



178. Jar from the Persian Period, found *in situ* in the anti tank trench at Wadi edh-Dhb'ah.



179. Wadi edh-Dhb'ah and Wadi esh-Shaqq, looking west. The site is in the foreground at right. In the center are the white cliffs of Wadi esh-Shaqq, and in the background is high Jebel Mu'allakah. The area was settled during many periods; the anti tank trench exposed the site, which had been buried in the ground. 1988.



Site 77: 19 – 19/34/2

'Iraq el-Mardom

Israel grid: 1939 1946

UTM grid: 7320 5821

Elevation: 117 m a.s.l., 50 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean

brown forest soil; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain el-Hammeh, no. 116), 4.5 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 2 km distant

Visibility: 3

June 12, 1992; 48 shards

* * *

A farm complex in a narrow ravine in a hilly area, 2 km northwest of

Hamam el-Malih. A dirt road from Wadi Malih to Kh. Jabar is passes

nearby.

The site is comprised of a central structure and a courtyard, located upon a flat area at the bottom of a slope and above a gorge, a tributary of Wadi el-Mhallal. The main building (8x25 m in size) is divided into three areas, approximately equal in size. The eastern one is empty, while the two western ones have secondary divisions, including inner walls and one cell. The outer walls are built of large stones, while the inner walls are of smaller ones. The masonry is of good quality.

North of the structure is a courtyard built of large stones, similar to those of the central structure. The yard, about 17x20 m, is irregular in shape. Adjacent to it on the eastern side is a long terrace wall descending into the gorge next to the farm.

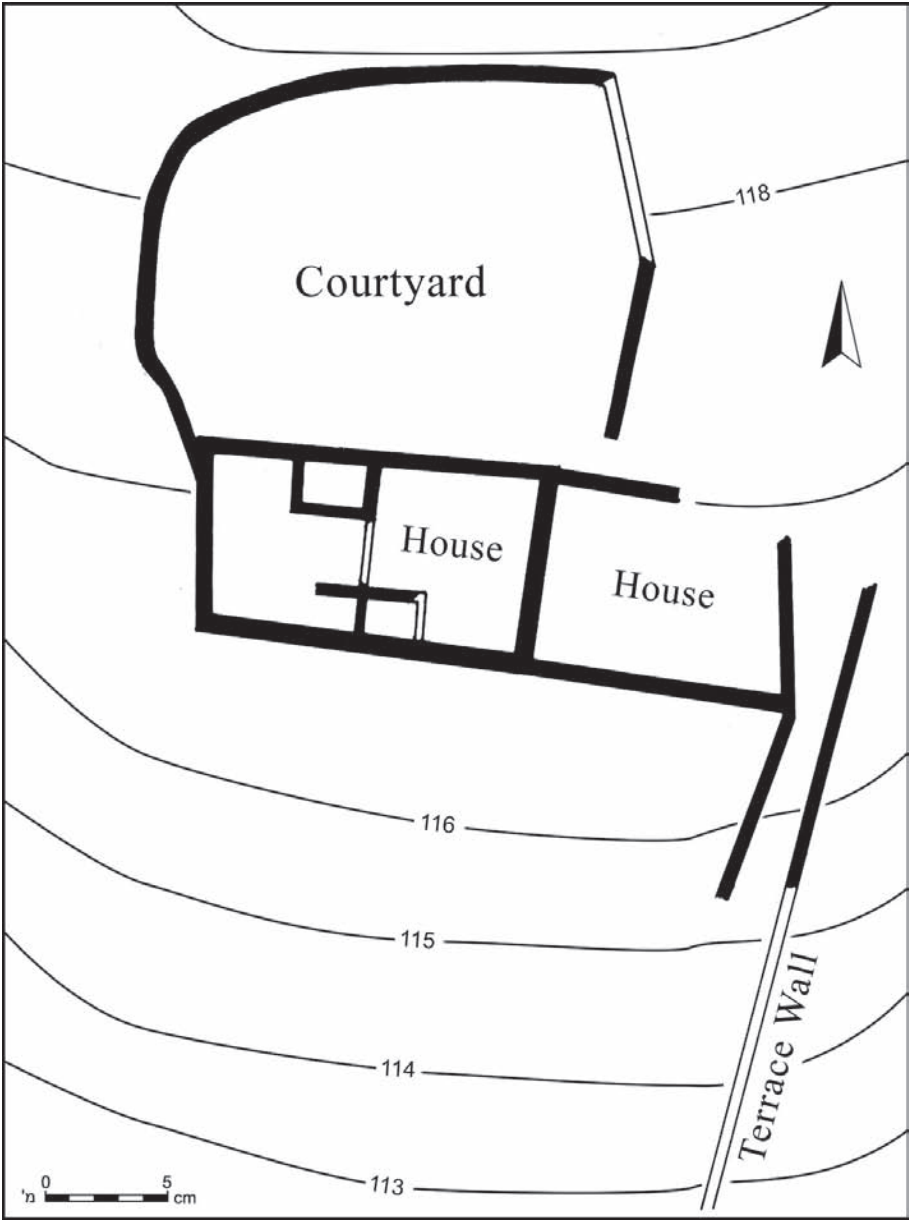
The farm appears to be connected with Kh. Mhallal, the large site in the vicinity.

Pottery: MBA I – 30%; MBA IIB – 10%; IrA IA – 35%; IrA II – 5%; Byz – 10%; Mod – 10%.

Previous surveys: none.



180. A view of the Middle Bronze Age and Iron Age site at 'Iraq el-Mardom, looking north. The structures are on a small step behind the jeep; the farm is situated on the edges of a small, inner valley. Summer 1992.



181. The plan of 'Iraq el-Mardom, with its irregular shaped courtyard in the north.
A long wall, a terrace and/or a dam, extends southward to the gorge nearby.

Site 78: 19 – 19/34/1

Khirbet Mhallal

Israel grid: 1939 1948

UTM grid: 7316 5813

Elevation: 178 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: large ruin

Area: 15 dunams (3.75 acres)

Topography: ridge edge, slope, valley edge and hilltop

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: terra rossa; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain Malih, no. 87), 2 km distant

Nearest road: Taiyasir – Meholah (B8), 2 km distant

Visibility: 5

July 1, 1993; Oct. 15, 1993; 96 shards, 19 flint items and three basalt items

A large site on a hilltop and a slope, near a small, inner valley in a hilly area, 2 km north of Hamam el-Malih.

The large ruin is comprised of

three main parts:

1. On the upper part, on a flat hilltop, remains of a site on an area of 3 to 4 dunams (0.75-1 acre) are found. This site ends in the east,



182. An aerial photo of the large site of Kh. Mhallal, looking northwest. In the upper left the high settlement can be seen, with the lower step to its right. At right is the gorge of Wadi Mhallal. Winter 1994.

on the edge of the slope, by wide, semi circular wall, which presumably served as a fortification wall. The site itself includes a central courtyard (15X25 m in size), with two complexes of structures north and east of it. They consist of many rooms with walls built of large stones. The structures are situated on two steps that descend eastward, with a ravine in the north. On the ravine, built terraces and a good many shards are scattered.

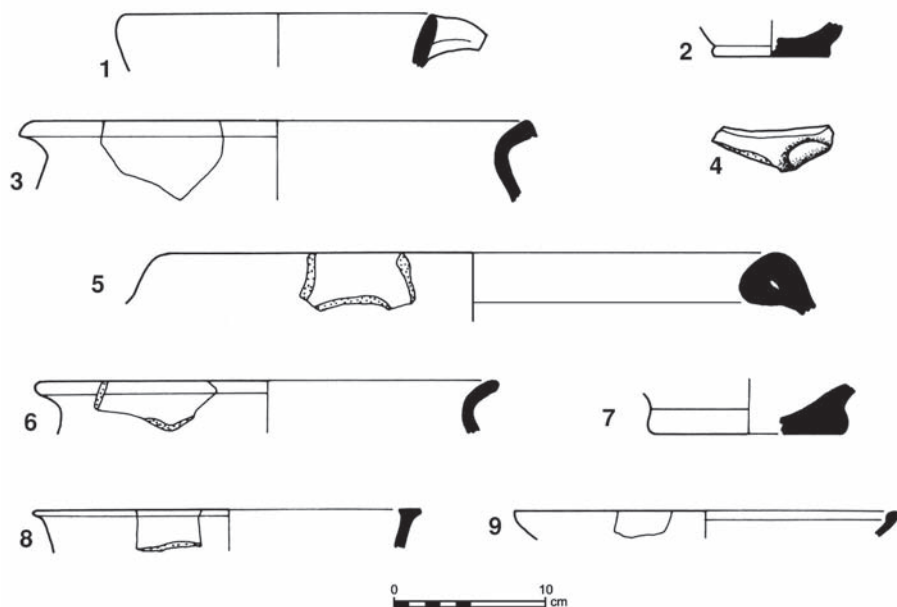
2. East of part A (see fig. 184), on the eastern slope, a man-made supporting rampart, extending over and across the slope, is located. It includes at least two supporting

walls of large stones. A considerable shard scatter was found on the rampart.

3. Four other courtyards, encompassed by walls of large stones, are on the lower step and below the rampart. Next to them there are several structures with rooms. East of this complex there are long terraces in the ravine.

Pottery: Chal-EBA I – 1%; MBA I – 10%; MBA IIB – 24%; LBA (?) – 1%; IrA IA – 36%; IrA II – 7%; IrA III – 3%; Byz – 10%; EM – 8%.

The two main periods of the site are Middle Bronze Age IIB, when the rampart was probably built,

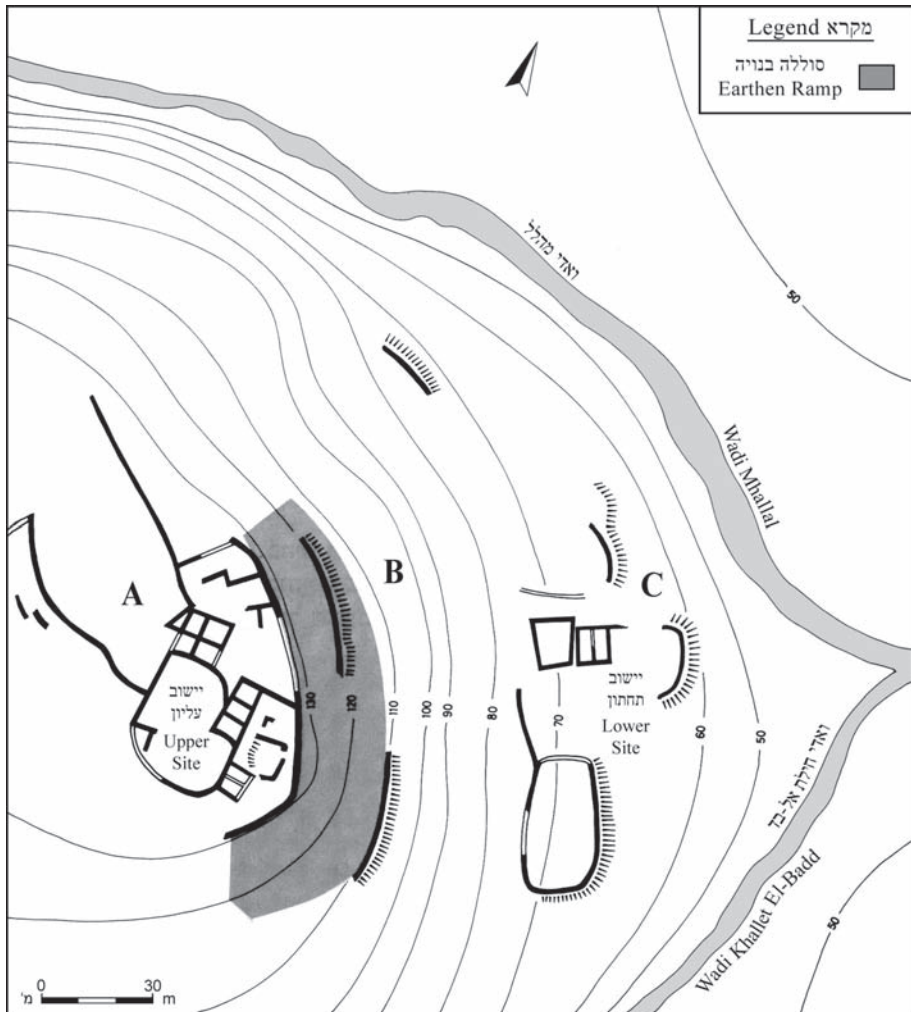


183. Pottery from the Bronze and Iron Age site of Kh. Mhallal: 1. Jug, br, IrA IA; 2. Juglet base, br, IrA IA; 3. CP, dk br, IrA IA; 4. Ledge handle, lt, MBA I; 5. Folded CP, dk br, MBA II; 6. Bowl, gray, MBA II; 7. Jug base, br, IrA IA; 8. Bowl, pk, MBA II; 9. Bowl, lt, MBA II.

and Iron Age IA. During the latter period the site prospered, and was certainly the most important site in

the Wadi Malih area.

Previous surveys: none.



184. Plan of the site at Kh. Mhallal. It extends over two steps, an upper and a lower one, with a man made rampart on the slope between them. During the Iron Age I this was an important site in the area, with a central role in the array of the Israelite Settlement sites.

Site 79: 19 – 19/64/1

Khirbet el-M'allaqeh

Israel grid: 1963 1945

UTM grid: 7343 5817

Elevation: 30 m b.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: high saddle

Rock type: Tiberias formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean

brown forest soil; quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain esh-Shaqq, no. 89), 0.7 km distant

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8, northern branch), 1 km distant

Visibility: 2

Apr. 18, 1986; 25 shards

* * *

A well preserved farm on a saddle in the M'allaqeh Range, between Shaqq and Dhb'ah Valleys, in a hilly area 3 km southwest of Meholah. West and east of the site are high mountainous ranges.

The farm complex is irregular

in shape, about 40x50 m in size. In its center is an empty space or courtyard surrounded by a series of rooms and yards. There are three such blocks: the first, south of the central yard, includes two long rooms 12X5 m in size with inner



185. The fortified farm from the Late Iron Age at Kh. el-M'allaqeh. The person stands in the central courtyard. Spring 1986.

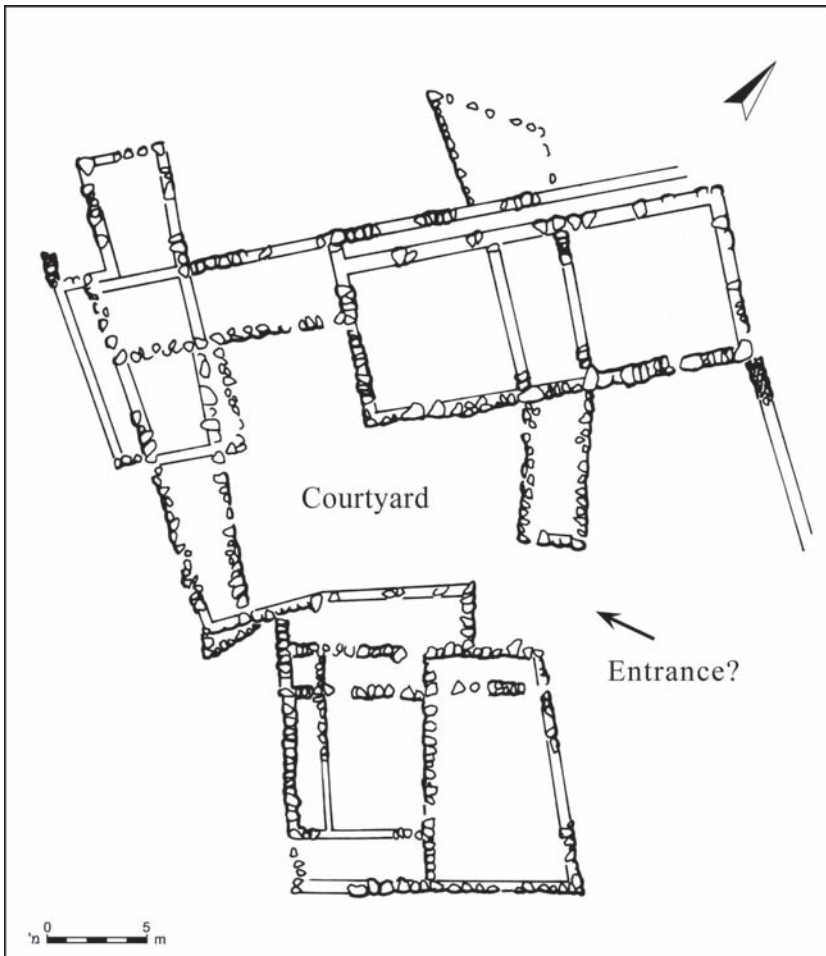
divisions. In the second, west of the center, there are more long rooms. The third, in the north of the site, is the largest of the three complexes, with two large square rooms and others beside. The entire complex appears to be surrounded by an outer wall 1 m wide; the inner walls are about 0.5 m wide. About 50 m north of the structure, on an upward slope, another square struc-

ture built of large field stones was found, 6x6 m in size.

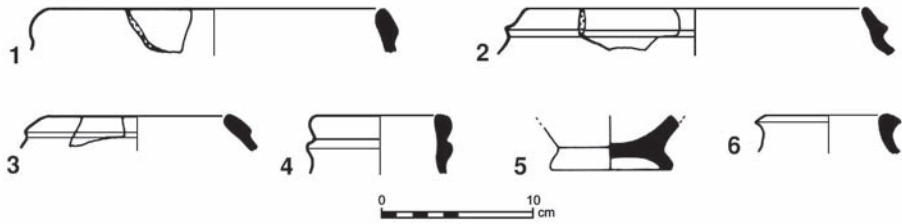
This fortified site, presumably a farm, is of the "courtyard house" type. The pottery dates it to the 11th-10th centuries B.C.E., probably abandoned in the 9th century B.C.E.

Pottery: IrA II (Early) – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



186. Plan of Kh. el-M'allaqeh. Note the central space surrounded by wings with rooms. Apparently there were several stages of construction at the site.



187. Pottery from the fortified farm at Kh. el-M'allaqeh: 1. Pythos, dk, IrA I-II; 2. CP, dk, IrA IC; 3. HM jar, br, IrA I-II; 4. Ridged neck jar, dk, IrA II; 5. Jar base, br, IrA I-II; 6. Jar, br, IrA II.



Site 80: 19 – 19/44/1

Wadi Khallet el-Badd

Israel grid: 1946 1940

UTM grid: 7325 5809

Elevation: 40 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: farm

Area: 1.5 dunams (0.38 acre)

Topography: valley edge and ravine

Rock type: Judah formation

Soil type: rendzina and Mediterranean

brown forest soil; quality: 7

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: spring ('Ain Malih, no. 87), 1.5 km distant

Nearest road: Taiyasir – Meholah (B8), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 2

May 25, 1986; 32 shards

A farm complex with structures in the hilly area north of Hamam el-Malih.

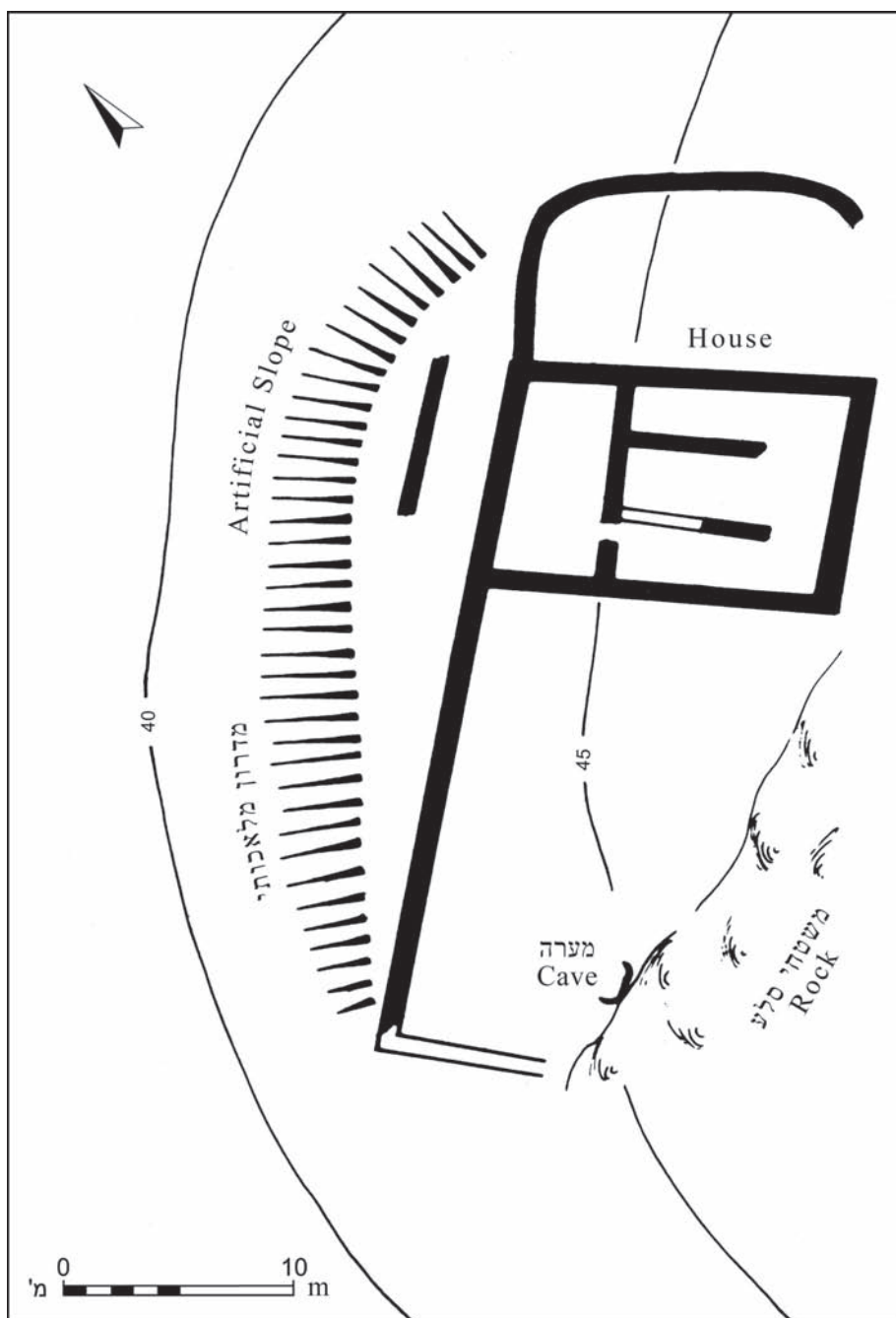
The site is at the fringes of a small valley, near a wadi descending into the latter. A 30 m long terrace wall supports an elevated area with structures. In the northeastern part is a large courtyard, 12x18 m in size, with a building divided into four rooms to its east. Southwest of it there is a square courtyard, 20x15

m in size, situated beside the wadi. Next to the yard are a cave and a cistern.

This farm, built during the Byzantine Period, was in continuous use in the Middle Ages and Ottoman Periods (16th-17th centuries C.E.).

Pottery: Byz – 30%; MA – 40%; Ott – 30%.

Previous surveys: none.



188. Plan of the farm at Wadi Khallet el-Badd. Note the man made step in the direction of the valley, the two yards and the cave which was in use when the farm was inhabited.